

# JADE PHOENIX

Sessions 1 - 3

May 1, 2026 - May 15, 2026

Jun 10, 1968 - Jun 14, 1968

## Cast:



**Handler** — POTUS47th



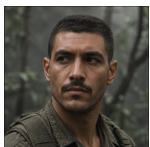
**MSG Cillian F. MacAllister** —  
Q.E.



**IA Bryan Carlyle** — S.L.



**SSG Michael Giles** — K.G.



**SSG Nuair A. al-Attar** — X.A.

## JP SESSION 1

May 1, 2026

Jun 10, 1968 - Jun 12, 1968

**Chandu:** *CHAPTER I - JADE PHOENIX*

*"We make war that we may live in peace."- Aristotle, Nicomachean Ethics.*

**Chandu:** *McLean, Virginia, 10 JUN 1968 1200R*

**Chandu:** *It's a great day outside. Frank phoned over an hour ago-- nine holes at the clubhouse at four o'clock. This is exactly the sort of day you pictured in your mind as you felt your skin melting away in Saigon and thought of "leave".*

**Chandu:** *You've been back home for two weeks, and you've two more weeks to go. It is, indeed, a great day to be an American.*

**Chandu:** *You're hanging out in your living room. And speaking of lunch-- you catch a scent from the kitchen. You needn't check-- it's Margaret's meatloaf casserole. Anything you could say about her, that woman can cook.*

**Chandu:** *About the newspaper you're holding in your hands...*

**Chandu:** *"MARTIN LUTHER KING JR's ASSASSIN CAPTURED"*

**Chandu:** *"SEN. ROBERT F. KENNEDY RETURNED TO NY FOR FUNERAL"*

**Chandu:** *"PROTESTERS AGAINST WAR GATHER IN D.C."*

**Chandu:** *These headlines aren't exactly setting the right mood, but what're you gonna do about it? What's on your mind, anyway?*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** *It's unfortunate, but nothing new in my eyes. The world is ran by imbeciles who live to eat sausages all day until they void their last meal into a bedpan. But as long as I'm doing well, what is there to complain about? And I'm doing very well indeed.*

**Chandu:** *Just so. You hear footsteps approaching from the kitchen...*

**Margaret Carlyle:** "So, you never tell me much about your time abroad. How was, uh... was it Munich?"

**Chandu:** *She still thinks you're in the automotive business.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Good as ever, Margie. Say what you want about the krauts, they know how to put a car together."

**Margaret Carlyle:** "Ha. I only wish you'd bring more pictures!"

**Margaret Carlyle:** As she walks back over to the kitchen, you hear the phone ringing.

**Margaret Carlyle:** "Can you get that, honey? Kinda busy here!"

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Yes, yes..." I lazily reach for the set before realizing I'll have to get up to take it.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Hello?"

**Chandu:** *A man's voice. One you don't recognize.*

**Phone:** "The monsoon missed Rangoon this year."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** Ah. You know the answer to this one.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Awfully Delphic of you. Uhh, 'The king still swings in Mandalay.'"

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** Your ears start to ring as you recite the words back, as in command. Where'd that headache come from?

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** One thing's for sure... your week's most certainly about to be ruined.

**Chandu:** *HEADQUARTERS 20 MINUTES LATER*

**Chandu:** *You walk past the reception desk in a haze. You don't need to ask-- you know exactly where you're needed. That specific activation sentence carries a specific meaning with it.*

**Chandu:** *Brown stands at the head of the table, businesslike. A projector is taking up his attention: he simply shoots you a nod as you enter.*

**Chandu:** *Twenty seconds later, he's about done. The lights dim, the projector comes on.*

**IA Jebediah Brown:** "Alright. I'll make this a short one. You're headed back to Vietnam. I know I'm shitting all over your parade here, but give me a fuckin' break."

**IA Jebediah Brown:** "Figure rippin' the bandaid straight off'd do you less harm."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "I'm more worried about what the rush is. I can only imagine it'd take a thorough Rogering for me to be called back like this..."

**IA Jebediah Brown:** "Yeah, yeah. I think you're gonna like this one."

**IA Jebediah Brown:** "Right. This is a joint effort with the boys at Kontum MACV. All the paperwork you need to know is that this falls under the purview of Operation Momentum and a narcotics interdiction campaign."

**IA Jebediah Brown:** He clicks the projector's control, sliding the first panel in frame.

**Chandu:** *Slide 1: A Burmese officer's file. Lung Li Bao, with the Tatmadaw.*

**IA Jebediah Brown:** "This is Lung Li Bao. Officially, a Tatmadaw deserter turned Shan warlord. Unofficially, this guy's backed by the KMT, which nominally puts him squarely in our camp. Unfortunately for Mr. Lung, he's become a liability for our wider anti-communist network in the area."

**Chandu:** *Slide 2: Heroin packets ready for shipping, intercepted in Saigon, 1967.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "As is wont to happen."

**IA Jebediah Brown:** "Intelligence suggests that the man's engaging with the Indochina narcotics trafficking network to fund his military operations in the area. Informants place these shipments as travelling down the Mekong river into Saigon, where they are then shipped elsewhere."

**IA Jebediah Brown:** "Our intel is really fuckin' scanty on this one, but we've got a read on his location thanks to local contacts."

**Brig. Gen. Michael Stillman:** As Brown sets the third slide over the projector, the door opens. In slides an older man wearing the uniform and rank tabs of a USAF Brigadier General. His tag reads STILLMAN.

**Brig. Gen. Michael Stillman:** He nods at Brown, who shoots him a nod back before continuing. He walks over to the back of the room.

**IA Jebediah Brown:** "We've narrowed down Lung's whereabouts to this settlement in the Laos-Burma border, Wan Bok-aw. This place has turned into a distribution hub for their unrefined product."

**IA Jebediah Brown:** "Place's built on top of a Buddhist temple, if you can imagine that sort of desecration."

**IA Jebediah Brown:** "Alright. Your objective is to eliminate Lung Li Bao, and if possible, to obtain photographic or physical evidence of his operation in Wan Bok-aw for our official report."

**IA Jebediah Brown:** "Insertion and transit towards the objective area is being handled by MACV at Da Nang. Timeline's tight-- meet up with our boys and go from there..."

**IA Jebediah Brown:** He pauses and looks over your shoulder at Stillman for a second or two.

**IA Jebediah Brown:** He then... checks his wristwatch.

**IA Jebediah Brown:** "I uh-- the rest of the details you'll get at Da Nang, alright? Somewhere I ought ta be right about now."

**IA Jebediah Brown:** "Figure it out."

**IA Jebediah Brown:** He picks all of his shit up in a rush and makes away with a quickness unseen.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I'm about to ask what's with the urgency but he's gone before I can say anything. "You'd have thought he soiled himself." I say to Stillman.

**Brig. Gen. Michael Stillman:** He emerges from the back of the room and heads over to the projector as you speak, left on by Brown. The air in the room shifts as the compartmentalization becomes clear.

**Brig. Gen. Michael Stillman:** "He hasn't got our clearance, Carlo."

**Chandu:** *There's that ringing again.*

**Brig. Gen. Michael Stillman:** "Let's get to the real reason you're here." He produces a slim folder and draws a set of slides from it.

**Chandu:** *Slide 1: This one's got a little green triangle in one of the corners. An old mugshot of a Chinese man-- any older and it'd be an oil painting. Green triangle on the bottom right.*

**Brig. Gen. Michael Stillman:** "The organization knows this man as Ming Yuan. You'll find no record of him in the Agency's archives, of course."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Handsome fellow."

**Brig. Gen. Michael Stillman:** "You think so?" He chuckles. "This picture dates back to 1911. He was arrested in the Bay Area for racketeering and deported to Guangzhou."

**Chandu:** *Slide 2: A bloody cellar in Chinatown, San Francisco. You recognize the Chinese Triad ritual paraphernalia. You also note the trashbags.*

**Brig. Gen. Michael Stillman:** "His handiwork back in the day, human sacrifices. A local asset worked out the connection between Yuan and the Kuen Yui "deathless" cult at the time, after he vanished."

**Brig. Gen. Michael Stillman:** He raises the slide of Lung Li Bao. "New intelligence places him in Wan Bok-aw. His role and connection to Lung Li Bao are indeterminate as of now, but we believe that he may be acting at an advisory capacity."

**Brig. Gen. Michael Stillman:** "To what end-- that is unknown."

**Brig. Gen. Michael Stillman:** "That being said, Executive Command wants him dead. You are to eliminate him and, if possible, recover any ritual artifacts or books for further analysis." He pauses, placing his hands on the table.

**Brig. Gen. Michael Stillman:** "Questions so far?"

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Well if he's still out and able to murder people now, and we knew about him back when China was still an empire, it sort of vindicates whatever rituals they're doing. What else is this cult meant to be capable of, other than immortality?"

**Brig. Gen. Michael Stillman:** "Reports from 1911 are unreliable, to say the least. We've got him butchering people in Chinatown, that much is clear."

**Brig. Gen. Michael Stillman:** "As you can most definitely infer from their given name, the 'deathless' have a particular fixation for the unnatural extension of a human's given time on God's green earth."

**Brig. Gen. Michael Stillman:** "It's been nearly sixty years since he slipped through the cracks thanks to nominal law enforcement. There's no way to tell what means they might've uncovered by now."

**Brig. Gen. Michael Stillman:** "You'll have to acquire intelligence and act accordingly on site."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Well, it was worth asking. Sort of queers the pitch, having the KMT guy working with him... I don't suppose we'll have any more than a few soldiers at our disposal."

**Brig. Gen. Michael Stillman:** "We've worked closely with MACV in the theater since the beginning of the war. Everyone involved has worked with us to some or other capacity."

**Brig. Gen. Michael Stillman:** "That is to say that you'll work with a small, but reliable bunch."

**Brig. Gen. Michael Stillman:** "One more thing. Your case officer, Agent Carstairs, is on site at Da Nang. You'll meet at the operational briefing with MACV upon your arrival."

**Brig. Gen. Michael Stillman:** "Anything related to insertion, extraction, local support and anything on the ground-- hash it out in Da Nang."

**Brig. Gen. Michael Stillman:** "You've got a day's worth of flying ahead of you. I'll let you go ahead and make an excuse for your wife back home."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** He smiles. "You'll be happy to know I like a good challenge, sir."

**Brig. Gen. Michael Stillman:** "You don't have to impress me, son." The two of you stand and shake hands before you leave.

**Chandu:** *Somewhere over the Pacific Ocean*

**Chandu:** *The trip west passes in timetables, stale coffee and the particular annoyance of jetlag. Your itinerary lists civilian transport from Norfolk to Anchorage to Okinawa, then a military plane on final approach.*

**Chandu:** *By the time the C-130's cargo hold intecomm announces the approach to Da Nang, a little less than a full day after your briefing, you're tired, despite having done your best to sleep through the airtime.*

**Chandu:** *And even then...*

**Chandu:** *You feel a sort of calmness as the rear platform opens up. A warm and humid gust of wind washes over your face.*

**Chandu:** *Welcome to Da Nang.*

**Chandu:** *Da Nang AB, Vietnam 11 JUN 1968 2210R*

**Chandu:** *MACV-- although the nighttime would still be considered hard to breathe back in the States, you've gotten used to it by now.*

**Chandu:** *This is, at minimum, your third tour of duty for the youngest of you. You weren't forced to come to Vietnam, nor to join SOG.*

**Chandu:** *You volunteered.*

**Chandu:** *The fan's blades are slapping the heat around without helping much. The room's smoked an entire pack's worth of cigarettes down to the filter by now. Captain Doyle, with Command & Control North here at Da Nang, is standing over the table, hands set upon it.*

**Chandu:** *The "CIA case officer" got done stressing the importance of Ming Yuan over Lung Li Bao a few minutes ago. To at least two of the men in the room, this broad looks more like she'd belong behind a casserole dish than at the head of a black op.*

**Chandu:** *The room's been mostly silent in waiting since air traffic called in the plane carrying the spook you're taking into the bush some ten minutes ago. What're each of you thinking about as you wait?*

**SSG Michael Giles:** I already put up with a cracker giving me orders and now we have a cracker bitch yapping in here. What the fuck?

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Curious and bored.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm thinking our demographic composition represents a student rally more than it does the briefing room for a clandestine operation.

**Chandu:** *Too true. Soon enough, some manner of equalizer comes in through the door..*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** Carlyle, you walk through the doorless entryway expecting some measure of reprieve from the heat. You don't find any-- instead, five sets of eyes all look over your way as you step inside.

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "Right on time." He holds his hand out. "Major Arthur Doyle. I've been holding this team in place while up top decided whether the operation was happening or not."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Good evening." He shakes his hand, genuinely jovial at being back in Vietnam in a manner. Wonderful place - the locals are all so nice, and the pagodas...

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "I suppose we've all been briefed then."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Did no one tell Viking over here he missed the last row-boat to Norway?"

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Slim-white's gonna need a new change of clothes after he soaks these with sweat, man."

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "Gotta get that pretty face dirty."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "I'd pull you a seat next to me but you don't need to sit in the back of the bus."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** He looks at the other two and laughs.

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Maybe he'll get it dirty after you crash the flying carpet again, brotha'."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Very funny!" He scoffs at Cillian. "If your Mick wife gave you that sort of lip I bet she'd have a sore nose indeed."

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "Y'all, introduce yourselves, gentlemen. You'll be working closely together."MACV-- names and ranks, and one visible first impression for everyone.

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Mike Giles, baddest mothafucka' this side of the Mekong, baby," he points at his name and rank patch "Don't worry boy I'm going to get you out the ghetto safe and sound," he says with his legs kicked up on the table. He looks like he doesn't care one lick about anything, least of all the operation.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Just call me Cillian. Anything about pots of gold and I'll make you a new one."He picks up his knife stuck to the table and nods to it once, before sheathing it.

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Yeah put that shit back mane you done scared the white boy enough."

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Nuaiar chuckles before leaning back in his seat. "Name's Nuaiar, you can call me Nolan."

**IA Ruth C. Martí:** "Ruth Martí." She nods your way, Carlyle, and gestures towards a seat. This is your CIA and DG case officer, CARSTAIRS. No time for elaborate introductions.

**SSG Michael Giles:** Mike kicks off his legs from the table and leans in, "Yo slim - two questions. One: you comfortable with the presence of a black man? Two: you got any menthols on you?"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "He looks like he invented the presence of black men."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** He laughs, clearly enjoying the hazing more than anything. "If you're gonna hit me with this Dirty Dozen shtick, you know you have to back it up in the field, right? 'Cause I'll be laughing to the grave if you get shot by the first Chinaman we find."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "And come on, I'm not some Dixie."

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "Let's get the fuck into it, we've got a fire under our asses. Take a seat, Mr. Carlyle."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** He takes that seat without another word.

**SSG Michael Giles:** Clicks his tongue: "Maaan. This a whole squad of different shades of black and he ain't got it in him. He won't do any better in country," he says as he nods up at Cillian.

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "We're clear on our targets. Insertion goes at 0200R, four hours from now. We're hitching a ride on a single bird carrying supplies to a Hmong contact in the area. Here's our first logistical problem..."

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "Your insertion point is just short of 17 kilometers away from Wan Bok-aw, making it about a day's march there, a day's march back. Weather forecast is calling a freak monsoon hitting the peninsula in just over three days..."

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "Meaning you've got about 24 hours to perform field recon and execute your objectives at the compound."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** He looks at Giles. "You're right that I'm not a soldier. Good thing we have three very fine soldiers here to do all the shooting for me."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Oh boy..."

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "Listen up. The monsoon presents a problem the size of your highschool sweetheart's ass, we're not joking here. If it breaks before pickup, the bird may be physically unable to get out."

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "Moving on, local support. You'll note the absence of our two trusted locals-- they got pulled under Colonel Wade's authority."

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "Can't call the shots against the big guy, and fuck knows what he's got on his plate. Unfortunately, we do not have replacements with clearance who we can get to in time."

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "This means that you are shit out of luck if you were expecting interpreters or handholding over to the objective area."

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "Final problem. Kuropas is off the reservation."

**Chandu:** *[TEAM] Kuropas is a MACV-SOG sniper, recently transferred to Da Nang from Ban Me Thuot (Command & Control South). None of you know the guy except for MacAllister: asocial, awkward, cold-blooded. All in all, a decent SOG operator. He's as much of a Delta Green asset as the rest of the SOG team, and he was assigned as your extra scope at CARSTAIRS' suggestion, noting the presence of two targets rather than the original one.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "And how do we see about solving that?"

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "Yeah. Good news is he's still in town. Bad news is you're going to have to fetch him in the red light district."

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "I wanted MPs on him two hours ago, they said nobody outside this room touches him, and nobody moves until our Agency friends have seen each other's faces."

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "You've got to be shitting me."

**SSG Michael Giles:** "We gon' have to save him from the clap, then"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "I have a couple ideas."

**IA Ruth C. Martí:** "Not to speak over the Major-- the earlier you retrieve Kuropas, the earlier the bird can get started."

**IA Ruth C. Martí:** "Buy yourselves an hour or two against the monsoon."

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "Yeah. We're already bleeding fuckin' time as it is."

**IA Ruth C. Martí:** "Absolutely. Leave him in Da Nang if he can't walk, I'll sort him out."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Worse comes worse, we'll just go swiiiiimming with the fishes." He finishes making a paper crane out of a scrap of paper and slides it towards flower boy.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "It sounds like we arranged all of this at the worst time possible."

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "Shit came up at the worst possible time."

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "Any questions before setting out to Tran Phu?"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Chance of air support?"

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** He puts the paper crane in his pocket with a smile.

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "Nil to slim. You are deploying on a Pilatus PC-6 Porter, twin engine bird. We may be able to get something going on, but it'll take at least two days to get through this bullshit Wade's laid out in front of us."

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "Worst case scenario, you'll have to come up with a way to get the locals on your side for additional ground support."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "If we don't have the ace of a bombing then this might as well be a one way trip. Oh well."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "And I figure since there are KMT assets involved that we don't want to make this too newsworthy, at any rate."

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "Correct. A quiet infiltration and exfiltration are ideal. If this entire matter can be chalked up to Hmong versus Shan infighting, all the better."

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "I'll get back to you on that air support some time down the line."

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "Anything else?"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "If Blondie dies do we leave him there or do we carry the bag back?"

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Oh, can it, you miserable bastard, I'm not planning to die."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "I was just making sure, since he ain't a soldier and all."

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "Asset denial, standard procedure. You know the drill."

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "What Mr. Carlyle is not saying is that he's a US Army veteran and served briefly with the 3rd division in Korea. Don't you worry about his bootlaces."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "A shy one."

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Nuair leans on the table to take another cigarette.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Well if I tell them that, I'm jinxing myself..."

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** MAJ Arthur J. Doyle chuckles.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "This conversation has been dragging on for too long. Major."

**MAJ Arthur J. Doyle:** "Alright. Kuropas, Tran Phu. Try and bring the fucker back breathing."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "We'll try."

**Chandu:** *Tran Phu District2300R*

**Chandu:** *The decadence announces itself long before you reach it. And the heat, it's still smothering the city, even after sundown. Artificial lights, neon and not, leak out from bars, game lounges, whorehouses, and... that's pretty much it. There's not much to do in Da Nang other than boozing, getting high, gambling and fucking. Music drifts in and out with generator noise, laughter, coughing, shouting in English, French and Vietnamese... you get the picture.*

**Chandu:** *You can see Marines, soldiers, and all sorts of locals out enjoying the nightlife, as if there wasn't a war going on. Some things never do change.*

**Chandu:** *Your man is somewhere in this filth. What's the move?*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "We don't stick out at all."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I know the man. Any chance I know the brothel or the plug he visits?

**Chandu:** *MacAllister, roll INT.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Failure** -> 89 (Rolling INT Target: 60%)

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Is this a common sort of problem? I'd have thought a MACV soldier buggering prostitutes at worktime would be court marshall stuff."

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Fuck, I could go for some too man."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "What does the guy look like anyway?"

**Chandu:** *You know about the shitpits GIs usually get lost in, and you also know that Kuropas isn't the type to go for the front row sort of establishment.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Man, slim, chill - ain't nobody give a fuck. Everyone's high on reefer and banging locals."

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "Nobody's court marshalling a man out for some pussy."

**Chandu:** *You'll have to "acquire" this intel somehow, and quick.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "The military judge meant to court marshal you may be inside one of these rooms, you know."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** In any case. I want to go to the most well known place in town.

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Half of the US Army in 'Nam would get court martialled if anyone gave a shit."

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "You should try out a massage yourself before you head back."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Alright, alright, gimme a description of the fucker so I can ask around for him."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna tell him he's a short black man.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Just to fuck with him

**Chandu:** *Mac: Tell him what you tell him, for reference: Kuropas is about 5'11, black hair, average build for an SF operator, ant 24 years old.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Yo, Nuair. They got reefer in Egypt?"

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** He then goes to the nearest street lady to ask in Vietnamese whether she's seen a short black man hanging around.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "Mostly hash. They bring it from Afghanistan."

**SSG Michael Giles:** "The fuck is an Aff-Ghan-Ee-Stain?"

**Chandu:** *IN ANY CASE: MacAllister, you can lead the team down to the joint most crowded with Americans in this part of town. Let's deal with Carlyle's interaction first.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "They live in the mountains and grow weed and pray all day."

**SSG Michael Giles:** "They sound like brothers."

**Working Girl:** "Short black guy? That's... like half of the US Marines here this time of the day."

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Sounds like they got it figured it out, I might go visit."

**Chandu:** *This conversation is happening in Vietnamese, of course, Carlyle.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "They might stone you. Unless you praise Muhammad."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Well, it was worth a punt," he says in English this time, to Cillian. "I suppose I'll follow your lead."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "I got big hopes in that Afghanistan affair. It's gonna really break out in the future."

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Muhammad, James Brown, Martin Luther King Jr. Whatever - I'mma worship whoever."

**Chandu:** *You're about there. You see a big crowd of GIs hanging out just outside. You can just approach the first guy you see.*

**GI:** "What's up, yo?"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Do I know him?

**GI:** Roll luck.

**MSG Cillian F. MacAllister:** 1

**GI:** This guy's an unknown variable to you. You recognize his patch: Corporal, 2nd MARDIV.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Is he going for a handshake?

**GI:** Sure. He reaches his hand out.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Do I see the patch too?

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I shake it back with both hands. "Corporal. Hope it's a fun night."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "We're looking for someone, any chance you know him?"

**GI:** All of you guys recognize the 2 MARDIV patch and his rank, of course.

**GI:** Let's see...

**GI:** You give him your best description of SGT Lawrence Kuropas with MACV.

**GI:** GI rolls **Failure** -> 87 (Rolling INT Target: 50%)

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "How many NCOs you think are out here for some action tonight?"

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "Can't be that hard to find."

**GI:** "Not a damn bell on that name, man. Still, MACV? Out here?"

**GI:** He pauses a second when he recognizes the skull patch on all three SOG operators on the team.

**GI:** "Oh, damn."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Everyone needs to have some fun. Some have too much of it, occasionally."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We're moving on with this guy.

**Chandu:** *You walk around the place for a few more minutes, keeping your eyes open for anyone of interest, or matching Kuropas' description. At some point...*

**Chandu:** *Giles. You spot a a young kid wandering aimlessly, a cigarette hanging off his lips. You might as well have shaken a bundle of Benjamins at his face by looking at him, for he immediately runs over to the group.*

**Kid:** "GI! What you want? You want good-good or boom-boom?"

**Kid:** "I get you ANYTHING!"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Can I speak enough Viet to tell him we are looking for someone.

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Yo, kid, you know a homie called Kuropas?"

**Kid:** 1

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Man, fuck, I got a hunch - where the place with the youngest boom boom you got?"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Not now."

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "Man, fuck off with that."

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Bear with me, man."

**Kid:** The little dude thinks for a sec as you describe both Kuropas and a place by that description.

**Kid:** Also, he's speaking shoddy English.

**Kid:** "I seen weird guy. He not buy smoke, no nothing."

**Kid:** "He just there."

**Kid:** "I bring you for one hundra dolla."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "How about a pack of cigarettes?"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "You're not grown enough for a hundred."

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "Kid's got an eye for business."

**Kid:** Roll Persuasion at a +20%, Mac.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Failure** -> 80  
(Rolling Persuade Target: 20%)

**SSG Michael Giles:** "15 bucks maximum, little dude."

**Kid:** "Eh.... I make you good price, alright? Fifty dolla or one pistol."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Alright.

**Kid:** "Fuck! You poor as shit!"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm looking at Blondie here.

**Kid:** "I take twenty!"

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Spot him twenty, slim. We don't want to give weapons to VC here."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "I know what you're thinking, asshole." Did I bring any cash?

**Kid:** Sure thing. Incidental expense for you, no need to fetch a telephone and reach into your credit line.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I'll give him a twenty and then another ten as a tip before ruffling his hair.

**SSG Michael Giles:** "He gon' grow up to be a Charlie and you a sucka for that, slim."

**Kid:** He puts the bills in his pockets and lights his cigarette before doing a "rally up" gesture, clearly imitating some American he saw do that.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "We'll be out before he can hold a gun."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "I'd grow up to be a charlie too if I was him."

**Chandu:** *Soon enough...*

**Chandu:** *Thien Duong. This shithole looks like the sort of place that should be trying not to be noticed, but nobody gives a shit in this day and place. The alley down the side smells like piss, cooking oil, and cheap incense.*

**Chandu:** *Plenty of people out front, but you can tell that most of them interested in the other joints, given the fact that they're standing on their two feet.*

**Kid:** "He here. I wait outside, ok?"

**Kid:** "You tell me if he not inside."

**SSG Michael Giles:** "I shoot you if he not inside lil' fucker."

**Kid:** "Shit! You black mamba, motherfuck!"

**Kid:** He steps to the side as to make way for the group.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** This is baffling. I'm walking inside.

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Yeaah boy, I remember yo' face. We eat fuckas like you in Harlem," Giles says as he walks in.

**Chandu:** *Inside, the light drops and the smell thickens. Sweet opium smoke hangs low, heavy enough that breathing starts feeling like work. Incense tries and fails to cover the rest.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "Kids got the mouth of a marine."

**Chandu:** *Men and women lie on mats in the main lounge, side rooms and alcoves. Some local, some American. You're pretty sure someone's having a deep conversation with themselves in here while the rest either stare at the floorboards or the ceiling up top.*

**Chandu:** *Some guy is trying and failing to sit upright in his stupor. Some other dude is trying to relight a pipe-- keyword trying, with his shaking hands. A GI is staring into the wall across while some Vietnamese chick fans herself by his side.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Cool smackhouse."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** In another life I'd be one of them. In this one I can only hope to be so.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Now lets just find this guy already.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "Man this isn't no whorehouse, it's a crack den."

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "Where's the intimacy?"

**SSG Michael Giles:** "What the fuck is crack?"

**Chandu:** *No need for anyone to make any rolls: Kuropas is nowhere to be seen in this particular mess. There is an upstairs, however.*

**Chandu:** *Proceed?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Yes.

**SSG Michael Giles:** "This shit look like the Soul Train green room, let's check up."

**Chandu:** *The stairs welcome your soles as you head up. Up here, the music's weaker, the air somehow fuckin' hotter, and the smell turns from smoke to sweat, perfume, and something "medicinal".*

**Chandu:** *There's a few rooms here. You can hear the sound of a woman moaning coming from one of them. There's another: the door is open, but it somehow remains uninviting.*

**Chandu:** *Again... Proceed?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I want to do an Alertness

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "...You understand that if he's here, there's every chance he won't be able to hold a gun by the time we're done."

**SSG Michael Giles:** "He probably shoots better on smack. Steady hands and shit."

**Chandu:** *There's no tripwire or punji stick, that much is clear. Hit the roll.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Failure** -> 76  
(Rolling Alertness Target: 60%)

**Chandu:** *You can hear the distinctive sound of... choking. It's as if someone's overdosing in there.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Oh shite."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm going inside, hoping for the best.

**Chandu:** *The disarray is clear, and the source of the commotion makes itself obvious first.*

**Girl:** She's lying belly down on the bed, froth at her mouth. You can't tell much else without moving in for an examination.

**Chandu:** *By the window...*

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** A young man sits on the floor against the wall. There's a military go-bag at his side and an M21 rifle leaning up against the windowframe. His head is hung low-- but high enough for you to recognize Lawrence Kuropas from the picture on his file.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Lawrence! What the fuck?!"

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles walks in behind Cillian - "Yo, yo bitch is ODing."

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** He raises his head, expressionless.

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** "She ain't mine."

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "Come on, man."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Give her CPR, now."

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** al-Attar moves to move the girl on her side.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I immediately try to put the lady in a position where she's less likely to choke on her own spit.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna walk up to him and grab him by the collar.

**Girl:** You place her in a fetal position together, Carlyle, al-Attar, in such a way that she won't immediately choke on her own spit. Her breathing's shallow.

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles looks around on the tables and dressers for shit to pilfer.

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** Mac, do you raise him up to his feet as you do this?

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Yes.

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** He doesn't resist, of course. In fact, he looks more alert now.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "She's gotta have a pimp or something."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "You've gone nuts or are you just high?"

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Fuck's he gonna do? He picks a fight with one GI he picks a fight with all of us."

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** "I don't do that shit. I'm straight."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Oh, in that case."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm going to throw this twat on the floor.

**SSG Michael Giles:** "They send these bitches to the Ho Chi Minh trail to dig the roads after they're too strung out and too turnt out."

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** You slam him down on the floor with a move that should be taught in schools.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Is there liquor on the table?

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** "I'm fuckin' moving!"

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Yo, slim - this probably ain't our fuckin' problem, so reel Irish in and let's get the fuck outta here."

**Chandu:** *Sure thing. Bottle of imported whiskey.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I'll have a sip and pass it to Giles.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "We got an operation in four hours and look at the shite you're doing here. You wanna become a murderer?"

**Chandu:** *Giles, add that to your inventory.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles looks on at the commotion and takes a big swig of the whiskey.

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** "She ain't fuckin' mine. She was here."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** He grunts and lets go of him.

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** He picks himself up and dusts his hands off.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I'm gonna put her over my shoulder and try to get her outside. We can't exactly get her to a doctor but anything's better than being stuck in here.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "What are we gonna do with her? Carry her to base?"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "No."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "If she's not suffocating she'll probably be fine."

**Chandu:** *Right on. You've got the girl. Kuropas picks his go-bag up and slings his M21 over his shoulder.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "I plan to make it some GI's problem."

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** He's still expressionless. Mac, you can roll HUMINT.

**SSG Michael Giles:** "They're gonna run a train on her, slim - give it to some civvie."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 37  
(Rolling HUMINT Target: 50%)

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Does he know what running a train is?" Giles says as he leans towards Nuair.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "You have a way with words, you know that?"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Then just set her up right and lets get the fuck out of here, at least she's alone."

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "Too proper to say it, that's for sure."

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "Come on. What are we doing?"

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** You don't know him in a personal basis, but you know enough about him by now to know that he's another victim of "overseas insanity" as some have put it back in

the States. Still, is deriving pleasure out of watching a Vietnamese whore choking in her own spit that surprising, in this day and age?

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** In any case, he seems ready to move, and done with the shit tests.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I'd rather do the bare minimum to keep someone dying than obey this Irishman I met twenty minutes ago, so I'm continuing to carry her.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I don't care if he derives pleasure out of fucking a bar of soap or this, as long as he wasn't trying to kill her, he's fine.

**Chandu:** *Moving back out front, then?*

**Kid:** "What good GI."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "I told you to leave her in the room. Now what?"

**SSG Michael Giles:** "You avoided death by black man this time, kid," Giles puts a 5 in the kid's shirt pocket.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I give the kid another twenty and tell him to get this chick to a doctor.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Yeah, just hand over a girl on dope to a fuckin' random kid. We got a real genius."

**Kid:** "Oh yeah. Ackshually, I know this girl cousin."

**Kid:** He yells something in Vietnamese.

**Kid:** "KAO-LA! YOUR COUSIN'S ALL FUCKED UP!"

**Chandu:** *Some guy jogs out of one of the neighboring shoddy French colonial houses and throws her over his shoulder. He gives you a sort of thanks in Viet, too.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles realizes that this bitch ain't any different from Harlem.

**SSG Michael Giles:** Replace black with yellow and it's similar strokes.

**Kid:** "You good peopre, GI. Maybe you save Vietnam for real."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "You have more money than me now. Take a hike. Fuck off."

**Kid:** "Hahahahaaaa."

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Yeaah we save vietnam lil' dude."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna kick him in the ass if he doesn't leave now.

**Kid:** He runs off down the street, pockets full of cash.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "And now that we've done the right thing, we'll all be in good spirits for the operation tonight."

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Real hero shit, slim. Now let's get out of dodge."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "This fucking guy..."

**Chandu:** *We can head back over to Da Nang AB if you're done in Tran Phu. So far, you've gotten yourselves Kuropas and a bottle of Jacks.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "How do you know that was her cousin?"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Jesus Christ Lawrence."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "I really don't care."

**SSG Michael Giles:** Ain't nobody drinking jacks in this bitch. This shit is 7&7s all day.

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** SGT Lawrence Kuropas shrugs.

**SSG Michael Giles:** "It's her pimp, man."

**SSG Michael Giles:** "He gon' smack her awake."

**Chandu:** *No further business in Tran Phu.LOADING DA NANG AB....*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles starts hailing for a tuk-tuk.

**Chandu:** *Da Nang AB, Airstrip0000R*

**Chandu:** *That entire business took up about an hour of your time, meaning that you are now two hours ahead of schedule.*

**Chandu:** *Back at base, you sort your shit out. You're geared up and ready to go meet the pilot at the staging area.*

**Chandu:** *The air over the runway is still humid, stinks of jet fuel and the place is still alive; you can hear sporadic jet sorties and hollering by pit crews.*

**Chandu:** *You spot your ride as you approach: Pilatus PC-6 Porter. The airplane looks tiny compared to the C-130s and almost laughably fragile next to the fighter jets.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna smoke a cigarette while I can.

**IA Ruth C. Martí:** Martí looks down the runway, standing cross-armed by the plane as the pilot performs his final checks.

**Chandu:** *You don't get long after lighting your cigarette until you get spotted.*

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** "Well I'll be goddamned!" he shouts, climbing back down off the step. "Mac!"

**Ssg Michael Giles:** "Yo, Irish - lemme borrow a cig."

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** Gabriel O'Riordan. You've worked with him before. Last year he was flying CIDG support and still wearing a uniform. Even before that, bigger planes. Tell us a bit about what you think of this guy.

**Ssg Michael Giles:** "Nevermind, fucker's got friends everywhere."

**Ssg Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "It's hard being handsome."

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** "Here, boah. Malbo Gold." He passes you a cig, Giles.

**Ssg Michael Giles:** Giles puts one behind his ear and sparks up Gabriel's cig.

**Chandu:** *Anyway, Mac-- thoughts on this individual. Concoct a sentence or two.*

**Ssg Michael Giles:** "'Preciate it."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I was distracted... Anyway.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "If the lakes were green I'd have thought it was Saint Patrick's..."

**Ssg Michael Giles:** "I know what you call them, slim."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Great guy. Don't know him very well but he's a descendant of Ellis Islanders.

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** So he is. He bursts out laughing at Giles' comment.

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** "Six months ago I'm hauling highland guerillas over to you bastards, now I'm taking you into Burma in a crop duster. Talk about a lateral career move."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "You got a simpler job than us, so, live a little."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna pat him over the shoulder and walk up to this chick.

**IA Ruth C. Martí:** She turns around to face as you approach, then looks over at Kuropas.

**IA Ruth C. Martí:** "Can he walk?"

**SSG Michael Giles:** "He lyin', man, monsoon's comin'."

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Ain't nothin' easy about this bitch."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "He's not on the dope. He's just a freak."

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** "It's gonna be a rough ride back, I'll tell you that."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "I'd like to know the real meat and potatoes of this now."

**IA Ruth C. Martí:** "Sure." She points over at the load of crates at the rear of the plane.

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles puts his arm around Bryan: "This our new friend slim. He been in Korea and shit."

**IA Ruth C. Martí:** "This is the ride the Major spoke about. Supplies for the Hmong."

**IA Ruth C. Martí:** "They're meant for General Vang Hawj by way of Sa-pi-sai. Here."

**IA Ruth C. Martí:** She passes you a map. For narration purposes, let's say all of you can see it now.

**IA Ruth C. Martí:** "The crates'll be picked up by his men, you don't have to carry them. Escorting the shipment over to Sa-pi-sai would be operationally useful. Carlyle should know this, too."

**Chandu:** *Carlyle, you're within hearing range.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "And then what?"

**IA Ruth C. Martí:** "You make certain that the crates are delivered to Vang Hawj. He may provide field support for the strike on Wan Bok-aw. The main mission remains the elimination of Ming Yuan."

**IA Ruth C. Martí:** "The Hmong have a set of crates to load in the Porter on the way back, they'll handle that on their own."

**Chandu:** *At a glance, you can tell the detour will cost you. With carriers and a less secure route, walking the shipment into Sa-pi-sai will add four to five hours to the overall trip.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Can I roll milsci land for a possible insight

**IA Ruth C. Martí:** Go ahead.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 43  
(Rolling MilitaryScience (Land) Target: 60%)

**Chandu:** *Using a CIA native supply+the assassination of a person of interest for cover for a DG operation is nothing out of the ordinary, really. Still that last part about the Hmong loading crates back: that's what's interesting.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I can only think of one thing, a trade.

**Chandu:** *Maybe you'll get the opportunity to check on it yourself when you're in the area.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** No further use in probing this shady bitch.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** If he was a guy maybe he could have symphatized with me.

**IA Ruth C. Martí:** "Anyway, as said: Ming Yuan is your priority. If you can guarantee that Vang Hawj receives the supplies, all the better."

**IA Ruth C. Martí:** "Keep the monsoon in mind."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm leaving her with nothing other than a doubtful stare.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "So?"

**IA Ruth C. Martí:** She turns around and heads over towards the officer barracks in turn.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "We do our job and we try to survive."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Couldn't be easier."

**SSG Michael Giles:** Takes a drag of his cig and says "Shieeeeeeeeeeeeeett..."

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** al-Attar shrugs, dropping whatever was left of his cigarette and stomping on it.

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** "I'd say I'm not leaving a countryman out in the bush, but you'll have to make them feet work. We're fucked if it starts raining hard on the airstrip."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Don't you worry. We're glad we're in good hands."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Now let's get started."

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** He snaps the checklist book shut. "Alright. Stow your gear and hop on. Wheels up in five."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** He stomps on his cigarette and picks the seat closest to the pilot.

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles tosses his cig somewhere.

**Chandu:** *The takeoff's short, rough and loud. Da Nang drops away beneath you in strips of light and darkness, then it's just the black of the countryside and whatever lies ahead of it.*

**Chandu:** *Somewhere over Laos, 0200R (2H after wheels up)*

**Chandu:** *The little Porter rattles like a toolbox with wings, cramped and overloaded with a weapons shipment for the Hmong, but it took off all the same. Inside the cabin, red light makes your faces look hollow. Your gear's inbetween your knees or by your feet.*

**Chandu:** *Carlyle still has that look about him. Kuropas is sitting quiet as a corpse in a church in front of Giles. The cigarette hanging off his lip is half ash, and he isn't swiping it away.*

**Chandu:** *This is as good a time as any. What are you talking about?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm honing my knife with a strip of leather held taut with my boot.

**SSG Michael Giles:** Doing last minute cleaning of Big Bertha, AKA the M60

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I'm reading *The Red and the Black* and occasionally having a posh chuckle at how similar Stendhal's self-absorbed aristocrats are to the current military establishment.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Writing in my notebook, keeping a somewhat censored journal.

**Chandu:** *One moment: switching Carlyle over to combat gear. Because why would he deploy in his civilian get-up...?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "The red and the black? Is that porn?"

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Yes."

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** What's Lawrence doing?

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I give him a glance as I finish writing a sentence.

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** He's actually looking at Giles like he's examining a lab specimen.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "Never seen a black guy before?"

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** The cigarette, mostly made out of ash by now, still hanging on for dear life off his lips.

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** He looks your way once, Nuair, then put his patrol cap over his head and eyes.

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** This guy's pretty weird.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "I know he's got the characteristic lips but you gotta keep that shit in the brothel."

**Chandu:** *The cockpit curtain shifts. O'Riordan ducks into the compartment with one hand on the frame to steady himself.*

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** He heads over to one of the crates tied down at the rear and starts fishing for something. He takes his sweet time finding it.

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles perks up: "Yo. This shit got autopilot?"

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** al-Attar leans back on his seat with a grunt.

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** He snatches a small plastic bag out of a bundle of luggage. He turns around just as you say that and sits over the crate.

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** "She's got her own mind, man."

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** "Wants to live just as much as you do."

**SSG Michael Giles:** "This guy been a hippy, man."

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** He picks away at the plastic bundle in his hands and grabs a pinchful of coca leaves. They go into his mouth.

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** Chewing, he points at Carlyle.

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** "That guy ain't Army for sure."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "It's not like I've been pretending, y'know. God willing, I won't need to be Army since I have America's finest gunning for me!"

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** He snorts and lets out a long belly laugh, still chewing inbetween.

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** "Alright. I'm outta here."

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** He disappears back into the cockpit.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Ain't you a handful."

**Chandu:** *You're left alone with your thoughts and the engine noise. The next couple of hours go by uneventfully.*

**Chandu:** *Four hours afterwards (marking six hours of flight), he flings the curtain to the side to yell into the passenger cabin.*

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** "Five minutes! Get your heads outta your asses!"

**Chandu:** *The bird starts dropping in the dark.*

**Chandu:** *Airstrip northeast of Wan Bok-aw, Burma0600R*

**Chandu:** *The engine note changes first, then the ground starts taking shape through the little windows in broken pieces. Fog, treeline, a pale strip of open ground hacked into the hills.*

**Chandu:** *The landing's rough enough to rattle your teeth. The wheels hit the dirt, bounce once, then again. The pilot fights the controls as the Porter settles into the strip proper. By the time the plane lurches to a stop, the engine's still chewing the morning air like it resents being here.*

**Chandu:** *The rear opens and the outside rushes in all at once. Wet earth and mountain air. Although it's still warm, it's a little refreshing... at least compared to Da Nang's urban particularities.*

**Chandu:** *The strip is barely a strip at all, just a rough clearing cut into the hills. It's long enough for a plane like this and not much else. The jungle presses in from every side. The Hmong are already unloading the cargo the moment the Porter rolls to a stop.*

**Chandu:** *Mac-- two crates are at your feet when you dismount, as the others get their bearings.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Any markings?

**Chandu:** *The ones being unloaded have Cyrillic written all over them. Russian, of course.*

**Chandu:** *If you want to take a peek, now's the time.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I do so.

**Chandu:** *You lift the cover off a couple of the crates. Wow.*

**Chandu:** *Weapons aren't that impressive, of course. But that's a lot of US dollars.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** al-Attar walks beside MacAllister.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "God damn."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Don't want to make the mistake of touching it, so I'm closing this.

**Chandu:** *You can also check out the crates the Hmong are getting ready to load up into the plane.*

**Chandu:** *Because, honestly, who the fuck's gonna stop you?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** That one I'm truly interested in.

**Chandu:** *You lift the lid up. These crates are an older make.*

**Chandu:** *These crates contain a load of bales full of a brownish substance. Roll INT, blind.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 53  
(Rolling INT Target: 60%)

**Chandu:** *Works. You're certain that this powder is morphine base, also known as heroin no. 1.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "How patriotic. Whatever."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I really have no objections to this.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Can I tell?

**Chandu:** *You can tell that they're drugs, at the very least.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Were we expecting any different? Surely the good we'll do killing off a death-cult outweighs a little corruption..."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "The what?"

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "What are we doing now?"

**SSG Michael Giles:** "The fuck is this cracker talkin' 'bout?"

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "You mean commies?"

**Chandu:** *Mac, you do know about Ming Yuan and the cult business. If it wasn't clear: MACV-SOG works in conjunction with the CIA and DG in Indochina.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Actually I was never briefed on the fact that we're here to kill "cultists" instead of taking care of a VIP target.

**Chandu:** *The briefing about Lung Li Bao by the CIA and Ming Yuan by Stillman (DG) was repeated in Da Nang by Doyle and Martí prior to Carlyle's arrival. We can assume everyone was just joking about deniability!*

**Chandu:** *Moving on: what's the move? Are you escorting the crates over to Wan Sa-pi-sai?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** This is pissing me off. I don't see a reason to escort the crates if we are not going to get any local support in return.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** Surely we're not dragging these on feet.

**Chandu:** *The carriers will handle the carrying, you'd just have to babysit them.*

**Chandu:** *The other option is heading straight to Wan Bok-aw and ignoring the Vang Hawj situation.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** Is there any way for us to expedite the delivery, somehow? We're not exactly drowning in time here.

**Chandu:** *They're about ready to leave within twenty minutes, it seems. Reaching over to the map...*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** Either way I'm in favour of helping them seeing as we're absolutely gonna be outnumbered when we make it to Wan Bok

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I don't wanna do this with no assurances.

**Chandu:** *You'd take the main path over to Wan Sa-pi-sai by accompanying the crate bearers and the two lightly armed guards they have with them. Examining the route, it should take five hours to get there.*

**Chandu:** *You can talk to one of the guards if you'd wish.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'd like to try that.

**Chandu:** *Roll CHA, BLIND!!!*

**Hmong Militia:** The guard nods at you as the crate-bearers get about ready to start moving.

**Hmong Militia:** He says something...

**Hmong Militia:** In Lao.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'll try my best to speak in Viet."You help us, we help you. If not, you're alone."

**Hmong Militia:** "Speak... Vang Hawj?" He rudimentarily tries his hand at Vietnamese. You can make that much of a translation with your ability.

**Hmong Militia:** He then points over to the path leading southwest.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "To be clear, I really doubt these guys are planning on getting one over the U.S military."

**Chandu:** *Another guy walks over. These two look alike.*

**Hmong Militia:** "Ehhh... Fran-çais?"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Oh boy..."

**Hmong Militia:** "No English."

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Let me talk to this dude."

**SSG Michael Giles:** I will interpret for Bryan.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I say salut to the guy and offer to chat with him in French.

**Hmong Militia:** Alright. Through your accent and his, Michael, two-way translation is a little complicated. Carlyle provides a hand, though.

**Hmong Militia:** You guys can speak to this guy normally, we assume you're translating back and forth.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I have no fucking idea what's happening so.

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Are we going to get help from the general or not if we escort you motherfuckers?"

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "My friend wants to know what help you will give us once we've helped you."

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles knows French bro

**Hmong Militia:** "General Vang Hawj will help you. He's a good guy. Loves America."

**Hmong Militia:** (BOTH OF YOU UNDERSTAND HIM AND ARE TRANSLATING)

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Oh yeah? What he gonna do for the good of America?"

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I stare at Mike in awe.

**Hmong Militia:** "I don't know, I'm not the man. You'll have to speak with him. I'm just a foot soldier."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Fair enough, let's just fuckin do it."

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Aight', let's get a move on."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Thank you." I say to the Laotians.

**Hmong Militia:** "We lead the way, crates in the middle, you at the back. We stop if we hear anything."

**Chandu:** *Path to Wan Sa-pi-sai0800R*

**Chandu:** *The Hmong don't waste time. The column's coming coming together with a sort of efficiency that just comes with practice. There's some muttering in Lao here and there, but most of the work is done with a glance and a gesture.*

**Chandu:** *The track is narrow and surrounded by green. The jungle doesn't hang over you so much as press in from every side. The air... well, it's back at wet enough to drink.*

**Chandu:** *The trail ahead climbs and bends through country and wet brush. Wan Sa-pi-sai is about 3 hours off. What's the marching order?*

**Chandu:** *Hmong guards are up front, merch is in the middle, then there's you. What specific layout have you come up with?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** If they are leading the path it's probably safer than anything we can figure out. We should stick closer to the pathfinders

**Chandu:** *That's the right idea. They circle around simple but nasty traps and lead the way safely.*

**Chandu:** *Half an hour further and the trail remains just as green. 2.5H to go, when all of a sudden, the pointman stops.*

**Chandu:** *The entire column stops as he does. The two guards look around, and so do you.*

**Chandu:** *Any two of you can roll Milsci (Land) right now. I'll allow just the TWO rolls.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Failure** -> 82 (Rolling MilitaryScience (Land) Target: 60%)

**SSG Michael Giles:** SSG Michael Giles rolls **Success** -> 43 (Rolling MilitaryScience (Land) Target: 50%)

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm looking for cover to dive behind.

**Chandu:** *Giles, you narrow your eyes in a particular direction that made your hairs stand on edge. You see them. The Shan, in the woods. All team members: since the Shan are spotted, you will start the engagement in Partial Cover.*

**Chandu:** *The first shot cracks out from the trees uphill and spits mud across the trail near the carrier, then the hillside opens up.*

**Chandu:** *Let's see if this shit works first.*

**Chandu:** *Did it roll initiative? I couldn't tell. Either way, MACV gets a free initial action due to alertness.*

**Chandu:** *Initiative dished out, go ahead and take your first free turn.*

**Chandu:** *This first action is out of the initiative order, to be clear.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm going to break out with the M79 if that's possible.

**Chandu:** *You have two possible targets: the more visible two Shan right across from the crates, or the staggered gunshots coming from uphill, to the right.*

**Chandu:** *Select your target and make your roll.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I think I'm the only one who can reasonably suppress the hidden targets beside the MG so I will do the 2nd.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Cillian raises the sawn-off M79 and fires a shot.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 88 (Rolling Heavy Weapons Target: 50%)

**Chandu:** *The shit JAMS. You spend your time clearing it in full cover until you're ready to act again.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Condition Changes Cover (Total) Cover (Partial)

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** It's one of those days...

**Chandu:** *Giles, Carlyle, al-Attar, you get one free action before we start going down the initiative order.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** What's happening uphill?

**Chandu:** *You can see the muzzle flashes, but you can't pinpoint how many shooters there are.*

**Chandu:** *You estimate three to five, rough count.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** I might need to push up and cut down some fuckers with the M60.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I'm aiming at the Shan guy on the bottom and I'll spend a WP to pierce armor.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I'll aim at the top guy.

**Chandu:** *You all have a firing lane towards both the closest Shan and the ones uphill, you can shoot right now or aim your guns.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** I'm just a brotha with a machine gun so I be shooting to surpress.

**Chandu:** *AS FOR ARMOR... these guys aren't wearing jack shit. No need for the WP.*

**Chandu:** *Make your rolls.*

**Chandu:** *You simply take aim.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** Condition Changes Aiming

**Chandu:** *GILES ROLL...!*

**SSG Michael Giles:** SSG Michael Giles rolls **Failure** -> 92 (Rolling Firearms Target: 50%)

**SSG Michael Giles:** Man

**Chandu:** *Hit the roll again with HEAVY WEAPONS since you're not up on your bipod.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** SSG Michael Giles rolls **Success** -> 57 (Rolling Heavy Weapons Target: 60%)

**Chandu:** *You're suppressing the ones uphill, correct?*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Yep.

**Shan Militia:** You cut down the vegetation around them, though they still have cover in the shape of downed trees and whatnot. You've exposed their positions, at least.

**Shan Militia:** Shan Militia rolls **Success** -> 42 (Rolling POW Target: 55%)

**Shan Militia:** Shan Militia rolls **Success** -> 39 (Rolling POW Target: 55%)

**Shan Militia:** Shan Militia rolls **Failure** -> 65 (Rolling POW Target: 55%)

**Shan Militia:** Condition Changes Suppressed

**Chandu:** *Now we begin going down the turn order.*

**Shan Militia:** Shan Militia fires a wild burst over towards the pointman.

**Shan Militia:** Shan Militia rolls **Failure** -> 82 (Rolling Firearms Target: 38%)

**Chandu:** *OK. That turn sorted. Nuair, it's your turn again.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Where did our sniper go though

**Chandu:** *You can shoot at your target now with a 20% bonus for your aim.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar rolls **Success** -> 20 (Rolling Firearms Target: 65%)

**Chandu:** *He's in fact at the back as well. Missed him, taking his free action to AIM in prep for his turn this time around.*

**Chandu:** *Roll damage.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** 12

**Chandu:** *Roll the bodypart table if you have access to it, too.*

**SSG Nuair A. al-Attar:** SSG Nuair A. al-Attar rolls 1d8 -> 6 (Draws a result from the Body Hit Location table)

**Shan Militia:** He is not in cover. He is hit clean in the chest.

**Shan Militia:** ////////////////////////////////////// A deep puncture tears a hole in the chest which immediately starts bleeding.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Is the one below not in cover also? Am I done reloading or what

**Chandu:** *You're good by this turn. He's not in cover, indeed.*

**Chandu:** *You can act now, Mac.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Was someone aiming at him or what

**Chandu:** *I think Carlyle was aiming at this man specifically.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Right. I'm going to partial and sending the grenade down at the guy all the way back

**Chandu:** *Hit it. We'll make no deviation rolls.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 36 (Rolling Heavy Weapons Target: 50%)

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Failure** -> 27 (9 Damage) (Rolling LETHALITY For M79 GRENADE LAUNCHER Target: 15)

**Shan Militia:** The 40mm HE makes contact with a tree right behind his cover, and he's splattered with shrapnel all over his back.

**Shan Militia:** Condition Changes Suppressed

**Chandu:** *By now you can hear more desperate shouting in Lao uphill.*

**Chandu:** *Giles, you turn.*

**Chandu:** *ONCE AGAIN...*

**SSG Michael Giles:** SSG Michael Giles rolls **Success** -> 57 (Rolling Heavy Weapons Target: 60%)

**SSG Michael Giles:** I keep suppressing those mothafuckas.

**Chandu:** *You're shooting in an ascending lane uphill.*

**Shan Militia:** Shan Militia rolls **Success** -> 7 (Rolling POW Target: 55%)

**Shan Militia:** Shan Militia rolls **Success** -> 40 (Rolling POW Target: 55%)

**Shan Militia:** This guy's ice cold and peeks for a shot at the pointman over MacAllister's way, since the man is out of cover.

**Shan Militia:** Shan Militia rolls **Failure** -> 86 (Rolling Firearms Target: 38%)

**Phet:** Phet rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 66 (Rolling POW Target: 55%)

**Phet:** Condition Changes Suppressed

**Shan Militia:** This dude is SUPPRESSED.

**Shan Militia:** He's going to attempt to suppress MacAllister.

**Shan Militia:** Shan Militia rolls **CRITICAL SUCCESS!** -> 33 (Rolling Firearms Target: 38%)

**Shan Militia:** Roll POW...!

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 53 (Rolling POW Target: 65%)

**Chandu:** *Though he's got a good cadence of fire going, you can tell that they were expecting to ambush a bunch of peasants.*

**Chandu:** *You're aware that they are unprepared. This is a bad ambush.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Oh they'll find out.

**Noy:** Noy rolls **Success** -> 15 (Rolling Firearms Target: 38%)

**Noy:** Noy rolls 1d8 -> 4 (Draws a result from the Body Hit Location table)

**Noy:** 10

**Shan Militia:** ////////////////////////////////////// The attack penetrates into the chest cavity to a disturbing depth. Takes a step back in shock and pain.

**Shan Militia:** This man is also SUPPRESSED this turn.

**Phet:** Phet, your translator, is SUPPRESSED.

**Chandu:** *Carlyle, you mark is dead. You can still use your Aim bonus on the ones uphill.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** Then I'll take a hail mary shot at this guy.

**Chandu:** *Roll it up. His head and arms are exposed.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** IA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Failure** -> 68 (Rolling Firearms Target: 55%)

**Shan Militia:** You swish past his head. He's staying low.

**Chandu:** *Finally, Kuropas is taking a shot at the guy behind him.*

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** Condition Changes Aiming

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** SGT Lawrence Kuropas rolls **Success** -> 2 (Rolling Firearms Target: 65%)

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** 13

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** SGT Lawrence Kuropas rolls 1d8 -> 8 (Draws a result from the Body Hit Location table)

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** ////////////////////////////////////// A deep puncture in the abdomen emits a jet of dark, red blood. Sinks to the ground as the pouring blood drenches clothes and stars gathering in a pool.

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** 15

**Chandu:** *By now you can tell that the Shan are no longer trying to spring an ambush, they're hauling ass to get out of one.*

**Chandu:** *One or two of them are still shooting from partial cover on the slope, but the rest are peeling back through the trees in ones and twos, in a rehearsed bounding maneuver, shooting potshots downhill as they go. The shouting's starting to get distant.*

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** Kuropas sets up his aim this turn.

**Chandu:** *Nuair, you're up.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Can I aim at the guys in the back?

**Chandu:** *You can. You set it up.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I aim for the unharmed one.

**Chandu:** *MacAllister, your turn.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm going to switch to my rifle and set up aim for the one in the back.

**Chandu:** *Hit it, apply the status effect.*

**Chandu:** *Giles, your move. Their suppression is clearing by now.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Keep keeping their heads down.

**SSG Michael Giles:** SSG Michael Giles rolls **Success** -> 7 (Rolling Heavy Weapons Target: 60%)

**Shan Militia:** Shan Militia rolls **Success** -> 26 (Rolling POW Target: 55%)

**Shan Militia:** Shan Militia rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 100 (Rolling POW Target: 55%)

**Shan Militia:** Not only does this bastard stay suppressed, he completely panics and breaks out in a run out of cover. You center your iron sights on him and mow him the fuck down.

**Shan Militia:** ////////////////////////////////////// Blood rushes out in a massive, red stream through the large new hole in the chest. Everything is covered with blood.

**Shan Militia:** Condition Changes Suppressed

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Get some! Get some!"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Can I just finish the other one with my OW.

**Chandu:** *Run your roll.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **CRITICAL SUCCESS!** -> 44 (Rolling Firearms Target: 60%)

**Chandu:** *Although this man is the one closest trying to flee, staggered gunfire is still coming from uphill, but getting fainter as the rest few Shan make their escape, badly injured. As for this man...*

**Shan Militia:** //////////////////////////////////////////// Enters through the eye, penetrating deep into the brain. Things fall apart, the centre cannot hold.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Not so smart now."

**Chandu:** *The hillside doesn't fall silent so much as hand the sound back to the jungle. Insects, leaves, the clatter of somebody reloading with shaking hands.*

**Chandu:** *Every Shan left here is dead, the rest have run for the hills. There's blood in the mud, broken bush, several bodies.*

**Chandu:** *MILSCI tells you that chasing after them is a wild goose chase, especially since you've got to lug these crates back. You wrapped up the engagement so quickly, in fact, that you'd be suprised if the survivors could make an accurate read on your numbers and the weapons you're using.*

**Chandu:** *The carriers are ready, with no casualties, and both guards are still alive. You're ready to get back on track.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Did any of them survive?

**Chandu:** *All of them lie dead as fuck. The ones that weren't perforated immediately bled out in the short aftermath.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Good, more convenient for us.

**Chandu:** *You continue down the path with your escort, this time in a deeper silence. It was short of ten minutes of combat and you were left with no casualties, still.*

**Chandu:** *Five hours into the track... the town comes into view. Wan Sa-pi-sai.*

**Chandu:** *As you arrive, the crate-bearers drop their cargo in a clearing by the village center. You look around, doesn't seem like Vang Hawj is here to receive you. A group of elders watch the Americans from the largest house visible from here, and a man and a woman over.*

**Chandu:** *This will be continued next week on SESSION 2. Thanks for playing...!*

## JP SESSION 2

May 8, 2026

Jun 12, 1968 - Jun 13, 1968

**Chandu:** *CHAPTER I - PART 2*

**Chandu:** *Wan Sa-pi-sai, 1100R*

**Chandu:** *Wan Sa-pi-sai sits on a fold in the hills, half-hidden by the jungle. Timber houses on stilts rise over the slope in uneven lines, linked by packed dirt paths and narrow steps cut into the earth. Smoke hangs low over the roofs. Chickens scatter out from under the first house you pass.*

**Chandu:** *The carriers finally stop in an open patch near the center of the village, breathing hard and shifting the crates off their shoulders and arms with visible relief. A few women and older boys appear with water, cloth, and a sort of tired efficiency.*

**Chandu:** *No sign of Vang Hawj as you enter. Every armed man seems to be a local militiaman.*

**Chandu:** *Give us first impressions of the village, make something up. Not bizarre.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** *It's a regular bamboo hut village out in the booties. Naked children running around, chickens, small livestock, open fires.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** *These people still haven't levelled up to concrete? The fuck?*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** *Villages like this are very quaint to visit but he's glad not to live in one.*

**Chandu:** *It's bumfuck nowhere along the Burma-Laos border, after all. You can tell they've readily embraced the technology known as the AK-47, at least.*

**Chandu:** *A short exchange in Lao passes between the carriers and a pair of older men standing beneath the largest house in view. One of the elders says something and gestures back behind him without taking his eyes off the shipment.*

**Chandu:** *The guy you spoke with in French along the trail points you to a roofed area where you can sit and wait. A minute goes by as you get your bearings.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** *"Y'know there's a good chance those are fighting chickens."*

**Chandu:** *Following the elder's gesture, some woman pops out and makes her way over in your direction. Her face is controlled and tired-- the good sort of tired, you know, from good old fieldwork. She briefly gazes over the crates as he approaches.*

**Sai Xee:** Carlyle, Giles: her French is accented and careful, but much better than anything you've heard since landing.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I thought of saying something witty in response to Bryan but realized it would come off as insanely gay so I hold off at the last moment.

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles would like to take this one for a spin fo' sho'.

**Chandu:** *FOR FUTURE REFERENCE: As long as there is a translator in close proximity, the full party is assumed to be able to understand AND PARTICIPATE IN the exchange. The translators may CHOOSE to withhold information by quickly stopping the narration and noting the fact.*

**Sai Xee:** "Welcome to Wan Sa-pi-sai." She nods respectfully then places a hand over her chest. "My name is Sai Xee. My father is one of the elders here."

**Sai Xee:** "You bring cargo for General Vang Hawj, correct?"

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I tell her yes and add that a beauty like her is wasted in this village.

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles adds that Bryan is actually into men and this was just a formality.

**Sai Xee:** She makes what seems to be an awkward face at that, but continues.

**Sai Xee:** "The General is not here yet."

**Sai Xee:** "As far as I know, he is expected. There must have been a delay on the trail."

**Chandu:** *Behind her, the village keeps moving in that half-watching way villages do. Somewhere uphill, a child is being hurried inside by a mother who doesn't want him staring at you lot.*

**Sai Xee:** "You may rest here while you wait. Food and water can be brought, if you are in need."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Might as well."

**Sai Xee:** She nods and gestures back at some kids who jog over to one of the houses. You can intuit said food and water is being brought soon.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I tell her that food would be great and only food. I don't suppose any of us want to shit ourselves to death from some tropical freshwater disease.

**Sai Xee:** She makes an understanding nod.

**SSG Michael Giles:** They can just... boil it?

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna try to use HUMINT on Kuropas to see how he reacted to that gunfight if it works.

**Chandu:** *As the kids bring over plates of roasted chicken and pig cutlets (they seem to be well-seasoned). The water they bring in warm pots doesn't look muddy, at first glance. They're left to the side for you to enjoy if you wish, either way.*

**Chandu:** *Go ahead and roll.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **CRITICAL SUCCESS!** -> 44 (Rolling HUMINT Target: 50%)

**Chandu:** *Every slight moment you glanced back, he seemed to be ice cold, focused on aiming at targets through his scope, in a way not unlike Nuair's.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Nolan resembles a human much more than this fucking guy. He's probably gone far off in the deep end between all this shit and whatever else, I think to myself as I enjoy the cracklins with water.

**Chandu:** *The first rush of arrival passes, and the village settles into their standard activity, with onlookers watching you in a curious manner. One of the wounded carriers is sat down under the shade of a stilt house while an older woman reties the bandage on his arm.*

**Chandu:** *The crates stay where everyone can see them for now, nobody making a move to claim them. How do you spend the wait?*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles is lazing out and seeing if he can't find a hammock to laze in.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna work a bit ahead of the schedule and try to eyeball roughly where grid coordinates will be through the terrain we move across, to call in shit faster.

**Chandu:** *Also, Sai Xee is hanging around while doing some village shit like working sheep wool or something. You can chat with her at any time.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I'm gonna ask around about the political situation out here and if anyone knows aught about Li Bao or any odd Chinaman associates he may be hanging out with.

**Chandu:** *Mac-- this is a simple affair for you, and you can triangulate fairly effectively with your map and tools. This'll be an ongoing effort until you reach Bok-aw, but there isn't much chance for you to fuck it up.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Just noting down references then. I'm not interested in small talk with these people, although this guy might.

**Chandu:** *Carlyle, you can ask your questions and receive a response piecemeal. Sai Xee's right there, and the other dude who spoke shoddy French is off to some watchpost.*

**Chandu:** *Meaning: ask specific questions.*

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** Kuropas is sitting on the wooden floor with his back to one of the posts, checking on his rifle.

**SSG Nuair A. al-Attar:** As for Nuair, he's also leaning against some support beam, doing the same.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I'll ask the lady how this place has dealt with the Civil War, then, before mentioning Li Bao in a half-hearted way since I don't exactly know which local warlords the folk here are or aren't sympathetic to.

**Sai Xee:** She can tell you that these rural highlands are mostly a transit location for whichever faction rolls through every now and again, be it any flavor of Burmese, Laotian, or unaligned. As of the last few months, military movement has overall reduced in frequency-- besides the warlords' forces, that is, Generals Lung Li Bao and Vang Hawj.

**Sai Xee:** Lung Li Bao and Vang Hawj's militias are in open conflict over this patch of the border. She guesses that's what the ambush was about.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** What's that about, anyway? Are they even on different sides of the war going on here, or is it just the classic Oriental thing where a bunch of warlords start carving out land for themselves as soon as a fight breaks out?

**Sai Xee:** She shrugs in a way that tells you that, despite sad, this is every day's lot since the start of the many independence movements against French and British occupation. It goes back to the mid-40s.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Hey if you really wanna fuck the village bike I suggest you do it indoors. Someone might be aiming for your head right now."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I just shrug. Presumably it'd be causing more of a ruckus if anyone here knew anything about evil Chinese tao-wizards so I'll just leave it there.

**Sai Xee:** Did you mention anything about that earlier?

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I guess I'll ask whether any weird Chinese folk have come passing through as well.

**Chandu:** *She shrugs, but tilts her head in uncertainty. Roll HUMINT.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** IA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Success** -> 41 (Rolling HUMINT Target: 70%)

**Sai Xee:** She seemed concerned about the mention of your wording of "weird". You figure you could go into a little more detail.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I laugh it off and joke that it'd be weird enough for a Chinaman to be all the way out here in the sticks in the first place. Of course, if they were communists...

**Sai Xee:** "Well..." she looks around. "People have gone missing over the last few weeks. Missing, never to return."

**Sai Xee:** "The older people say the dead are taking them."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Is that all? Because seeing as you're at war and all that could be a lot of things."

**Sai Xee:** "People who don't usually wander off, even at quiet times of the day."

**Sai Xee:** Sai Xee rolls **Success** -> 46 (Rolling INT Target: 60%)

**Sai Xee:** "Now that you mention it-- some of Vang Hawj's men were complaining about the same. I overheard some of the conversation."

**Sai Xee:** "They spoke of a man named Ming, who General Lung Li Bao has taken in as a close aide."

**Sai Xee:** "They also said the man didn't seem like a soldier. Not a deserter, like the rest."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I thank her for the help. We're waiting on Vang Hawj right now, right? Should make things less awkward if we're both on the level about putting a bullet in that guy.

**Chandu:** *That's correct. You wait for some three hours, making sporadic observations. The crates are still untouched, and no one's coming close to them.*

**Chandu:** 1400R

**Chandu:** *The elders remain sitting beneath the largest house overlooking the center of the village, speaking in low Lao with a kind of stillness. The armed men in the village don't crowd you, but they don't go far either. Every now and then one of them looks past you and back to the shipment, as if checking it hasn't grown legs.*

**Chandu:** *Some guy comes in off the uphill trail with no sign of the General and a few quiet words for the elders. One of the old men says something back, dismissive and irritated in the same breath, and then he goes off again without argument.*

**Chandu:** *Sai Xee, who seems to have overheard from this distance, waves in your direction.*

**Sai Xee:** "They say some of the general's men should be arriving in about an hour. I apologize for the wait, I suppose you have a reason to be here."

**Sai Xee:** "The General himself, they didn't mention."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Fuck..."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Let's just meet them halfway, then."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "My knees fucking hurt."

**Chandu:** *Roll INT real quick...*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Failure** -> 97  
(Rolling INT Target: 60%)

**Chandu:** 1

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "You don't suppose something's gone wrong?"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "If we went there now we would find out now wouldn't we?"

**Chandu:** *You reckon the trip over in that direction will take up more of your time getting there and back. You feel Inclined to wait for them at Sai Xee's reassurance.*

**Chandu:** *ABOUT 45 MINUTES LATER...*

**Chandu:** *As you wait, the village quiets down in a way that has nothing to do with courtesy.*

**Sai Xee:** Sai Xee's eyes shift uphill, and you can tell that something like tension reaches her face.

**Chandu:** *Five armed Hmong enter the village center and spread out without thinking about it. They're not ragged like the others-- they move like people used to carrying rifles for something other than self-defense.*

**Chandu:** *At their center walks a man with his rifle slung across his back. He looks over the crates as he walks.*

**Sai Xee:** "Chee Sawb," she says, quietly, in your direction.

**Chee Sawb:** He exchanges a few words with one of the elders, he replies curtly. Sawb nods and walks the rest of the way over to your group.

**Chee Sawb:** His eyes pass over each of you, not fearfully, but not carelessly either, before speaking.

**Chandu:** *[SAI XEE TRANSLATES FOR CHEE SAWB]*

**Sai Xee:** "He says General Vang has been delayed."

**Chee Sawb:** He continues in a bored tone.

**Sai Xee:** "The shipment cannot remain here in the open. He says he... has authority to receive the cargo on the General's behalf and move it safely from here..."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "We're being stiffed."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "I don't know who the fuck this guy is and he better show me a reason in physical form why I shouldn't blow his head off."

**Sai Xee:** She blinks and turns to Chee Sawb, calmly translating the feeling-- but you can tell that she's omitting the part about blowing his head off.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "...More or less..."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Go get the others."

**Sai Xee:** "He says he commands men in General Vang's service and that this matter falls under his responsibility now."

**Sai Xee:** "...and that the General will come when he comes."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Well smart guy. What do you think?" I turn to Bryan.

**Chandu:** *Nuair and Kuropas perk up at the exchange. They're both eyeing the other armed Hmong.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles hastily gets out of his nap.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "We really can't babysit this crate for any longer." I ask the lady if he knows this guy.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm just gonna do a test of machismo to see if he means business.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'll walk up to him and stare him in the eyes uncomfortably.

**Sai Xee:** She hesitates for a couple of seconds as you approach, Mac-- still facing Bryan. You can tell that she's choosing her words with great care.

**Sai Xee:** "He is trusted by some."

**Chandu:** *You can roll a relevant skill of your choice, Mac.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 4  
(Rolling STR Target: 75%)

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "What the hell does that mean? Is he with Vang or not?"

**Chee Sawb:** He subtly shrinks down a little as you tower a foot over him.

**Sai Xee:** "He is... with the General, I would say so."

**Sai Xee:** "But things are rarely so simple."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Any chance of us stalking these guys to see if they are headed the right way?

**Chee Sawb:** Before you make any further considerations, Chee Sawb says something in Laotian to Sai Xee, holding his hands up to chest-level as he creates a couple steps' distance between you and him, Mac.

**Chandu:** *The silence tightens. Sawb does not argue. He studies the Americans for a few seconds...*

**Sai Xee:** "He says he understands."

**Chee Sawb:** He turns around and heads over towards the elders.

**Chee Sawb:** They exchange a few more words, he sounds heated. One of the elders just shrugs at him and points at one of the stilt houses.

**Chandu:** *The discussion ends there, and Chee Sawb gathers up his men before settling into and around said house for a break. They're watching over the crates as they unwind.*

**Chandu:** *The hangers on seem to be just chilling at the defusal of the situation. They're not making any moves.*

**Chandu:** *Back to waiting. You may ask another round of questions if you wish.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I say in English: "If they're planning on selling those drugs under Vang's nose they'll probably kill us to get to them."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna try and detect any suspicious people around us. Not the guys standing at the house, I mean if any of them were watching from elsewhere.

**Chandu:** *You can roll Alertness, blind.*

**Chandu:** *The more raggedy militiamen, which you can tell are village locals by now, aren't really doing anything out of the ordinary. They're lugging logs and sacks around. Some of them are watching the center area where the crates are, but not with any urgency. They seem most concerned about Chee Sawb's interest in the crates.*

**Chandu:** *As for Chee Sawb and his men, looks like they're not partaking in the village's normal efforts as the rest. They're resting, as you are, and throwing an order or two for the locals to bring more water or food.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "I don't know. He didn't look like the cocky leader type to me."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "We have our own reservations here."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "If the general is too fucking late for his guns then why is it not his problem?"

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "How much longer do we all wanna wait here?"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Zero seconds. Let's just bid them good luck and move on with this."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Seconded."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "About the militiamen who were supposed to come."

**Chandu:** *You CAN tell, from your Milsai rating, that the guys Chee Sawb brought are somewhat better equipped, and the villagers haven't given them any pause. In any case, you can up and git if you wish.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Can you figure that out?"

**Chandu:** *Is that a Q for Sai Xee?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "I'm just looking for more bodies between us and the warlord we are supposed to kill."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Okay, then how about this."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "We tell Chab they can have the crate and we could care less if they skim some off the top provided they lend us a couple of their soldiers."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "..."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "And what if they turn out to be the enemy?"

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "After we've given them a load of heroin?"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "I don't fucking like this..."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Hey, it's your call."

**Chandu:** *Correction: you've brought gunz and US dollars. The morphine base was loaded into the plane that's waiting for you back at the airstrip.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** Still.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** He doesn't know that though does he.

**Chandu:** *I'm inclined to say he does, you weren't particularly subtle about lifting the lids off the crates. If you're referring to Bryan, that is.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** It's contraband they can make money off I doubt it matters either way

**Chandu:** *Anyway, the choice is simple: leave the crates and don't look back, try and make some deal with the impatient Chee Sawb, or wait for the CIA's contact.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Tell him directly that we're batting for a certain side. Any ifs and buts we're going to open fire."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Don't try to curve it."

**Chandu:** *We're calling Chee Sawb back over for a chat, then?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Yes.

**Chee Sawb:** Sai Xee waves at someone and points at the house in question. Someone shouts over. Chee Sawb comes jogging over after a moment.

**Chee Sawb:** He rests his hands on his belt and waits.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "The crate is yours if you give us some manpower. You know what we're here for, right? And when we've took out Li Bao you can take whatever booty he's got with him too, for all I care. We just need extra bodies."

**Chandu:** *Run a Persuasion roll, BLIND.*

**Chee Sawb:** As Sai Xee translates, his face lights up with a smile. He claps twice and nods, reaching his hand out for a firm shake.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Yeah there's no fucking way that guy is his own warlord."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I shake his hand all happy like.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Come on, let's just get a step on."

**Chee Sawb:** He shouts over to...

**Chee Sawb:** 2

**Chee Sawb:** Two of his guys, in effect. They'll join you and even offer to guide you through the trail to Wan Bok-aw.

**Chee Sawb:** They'll appear in the next scene.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Of course we're just a bunch of dumb mooks who think this guy and the general are one and the same, so it's no skin off our back if they find out he's stole their loot."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Let's go."

**Chandu:** *The team gets ready to get a move on. As you pick the rest of your shit up and Chee Sawb starts smelling the US dollar bills, realizing he's become a rich and well-armed man...*

**Chandu:** *You hear a commotion from over to the center of the village. Some guy is shouting at the elders, and some people have gathered.*

**Sai Xee:** Sai Xee frowns as she stands and heads over.

**Chandu:** *You can choose to follow. Or not.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I will follow.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** Me too.

**SSG Michael Giles:** Whatever let's go

**Chandu:** *Alrighto. You kick Giles awake, the other two will be staying, ready to move the other way uphill with the escorts once you're back.*

**Chandu:** *More voices. Not panic-- argument. One of the armed men near the crates looks over his shoulder at the sound. Another says something low to him and gets no answer.*

**Touhue:** This guy, he's the one causing the ruckus. He seems desperate, even getting on his knees and begging the elders for something.

**Sai Xee:** "Touhue, again..." she says, as she notices you're looking on.

**Sai Xee:** She listens for a few more seconds. A few more heated words between the two parties.

**Sai Xee:** "His brother, one of those who disappeared. He has not been seen since two weeks ago. Kao."

**Sai Xee:** "As you thought, most say the Shan killed him, he says... something else took him."

**Sai Xee:** "He says... his brother came back?"

**Touhue:** He starts fucking YELLING.

**Sai Xee:** "He says, Kao has returned to him. Not in his own body, but..."

**Sai Xee:** "Small?" She seems genuinely confused at the word.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "This is a load of horse shit. I hope they find the cure."

**Chandu:** *As always, you can Git or Investigate.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Actually I'm kind of bored so I think I will see into it.

**Chandu:** *Bryan, initial thoughts?*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** That we ought to learn everything we can about mister Chinese necromancer if we're about to get into a gunfight with him so I may as well investigate too.

**Chandu:** *Giles hasn't said much, so he's tagging along.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Giles is probably thinkin about watermelon and chicken so let's just go.

**Sai Xee:** Prompted by your interest in the matter, Sai Xee approaches Touhue and exchanges a few concerned words with him. Touhue looks back in your direction.

**Touhue:** He KNEELS at your feet and starts begging you too now, in Laotian.

**Sai Xee:** "He says they won't help him, and you must."

**Sai Xee:** She shrugs.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Cut this shit, tell him to stand up."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Let's see what he wants."

**Sai Xee:** She helps him up.

**Touhue:** He points to what seems to be his house, and starts hurriedly leading you over. Sai Xee's coming over too.

**Chandu:** *The house is cramped, hot, and smells of incense burned past usefulness. Offerings have been laid out on the floor-- rice, cups of water, ash, bits of cloth tied around posts. He's clearly tried three or four different things in here and none of them worked.*

**Touhue:** Touhue runs up to a low table and crouches down by it, instantly, clutching something with both hands without taking it off the table... like it might try to leave him if he loosens his grip.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I got my right hand on my M1911.

**Chandu:** *Right on. You observe.*

**Chandu:** *The table's arranged with candles and whatever offerings he must've scrounged up to remedy this bizarre situation. As for what he's got in his hands...*

**Chandu:** *It's small, hand-sized. A woven little figure of reed, cloth, and string, built in the rough shape of a person. One bead eye is missing. The other catches the light wrong.*

**Chandu:** *It almost seems too pathetic to be frightening.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I re-do the button on the holster.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "It's a doll. Great."

**Chandu:** *You turn to Sai Xee. Her brows furrow as she looks over the doll and the table itself-- you follow her eyes and she closes in up to it.*

**Chandu:** *Words have been carved into the wood in a hurried, ugly hand, deep enough that splinters still curl around the edges.*

**Sai Xee:** She clutches down on the cross pendant you now realize is tied around her neck. "N'est pas possible..."

**Sai Xee:** She runs her fingers just over the cuts without touching them, then looks up at the party.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I am well aware that, however ridiculous, any whiff of this stuff is bad news. Needless to say I'm gonna try and relieve him of that doll.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "You should make it a little house."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** That is, force it out of his hands.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "It, your brother, I guess. Ahaha!"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Come on, this guy clearly needs a good old lobotomy."

**Touhue:** He seems hesitant at first, Bryan, but hands it over, gesturing to be as careful as you can with it.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Put some tables in there, maybe wov him a wife."

**Sai Xee:** "It says..."

**Sai Xee:** "It is Kao. Help me. The dead man took me. He stole my eyes."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Stop being an asshole for a split second Cillian."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Bryan."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I look Touhue straight in the eyes.

**Touhue:** He starts speaking before the translation's even finished, fast and desperate, gesturing for you to hand the little thing back.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** Then I stomp on this doll until it's pulp.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I turn over to Giles-

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Hey-"

**Chandu:** *You can roll Unarmed as you toss it down on the floor. He's gonna try to push you over to prevent this from happening.*

**Chandu:** *The others can assist, simply mention it.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna land a fist in the guys face.

**SSG Michael Giles:** I ain't touchin' this hoodoo mothafuckin' doll.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 39 (Rolling Unarmed Combat Target: 60%)

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** IA Bryan Carlyle rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 66 (Rolling Unarmed Combat Target: 40%)

**Touhue:** Although Bryan steps back after dropping the doll, you interject his lunge, Mac. You deck him across the face hard enough to toss him down on the floor.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** 3

**Sai Xee:** She's taken aback and recoils back a few steps.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Why the fuck did you do that Bryan?"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Who's the asshole here?"

**Touhue:** He starts crying. Really pathetically, in a mix of pleading and anger.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Enough of this shit."

**Touhue:** Snot comes out of his nose as he cries and tries to speak. His nose is bleeding.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm shoving Bryan off.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Let it be."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "It doesn't fucking hurt you now does it."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Oh, whatever. It's nothing, anyway. But seeing someone reduced to this--"He tuts and lightly kicks the doll Touhue's way.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Jesus man."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "We're done here."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Tell him we can't help him. And we're sorry for this or whatever. It's just reflex."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We're going.

**Touhue:** He crawls over to it and clutches it close to his chest. Sai Xee is just watching nervously.

**Chandu:** *As you get ready to leave, you hear, from the outside... And PAUSE all akkkctions.*

**SFX: 2x pistol gunshots**

**Chandu:** *It came from the outside. You all draw your weapons as someone comes through the door simultaneously with the gunshots.*

**Gen. Vang Hawj:** The doorway fills. General Vang Hawj ducks inside without asking permission of anyone living under the roof.

**Gen. Vang Hawj:** He takes in the room in one glance-- Touhue on the floor, the Americans holding their weapons up, the offerings, then the effigy in Touhue's hands.

**Sai Xee:** "IT'S THE GENERAL!" She says, remarking the obvious so that you don't blow his shit off.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "It's three to one."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "What's going on here?"

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "He's not going to fight us, come on."

**Gen. Vang Hawj:** He says something hard in Lao. Not loud, but final.

**Touhue:** Touhue recoils instinctively around the idol.

**Gen. Vang Hawj:** Vang crosses the room in two steps, grabs the little figure out of his hands, and shoves him back to the floor hard enough to put him on his side. Touhue cries out and lunges after it, but one of Vang's men is already in the doorway behind him, and that is the end of that.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "..."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "You're here for the fucking doll?!"

**Gen. Vang Hawj:** Vang produces a lighter from his pocket with certainty.

**Gen. Vang Hawj:** He touches flame to the reed and cloth.

**Effigy:** The thing catches faster than it should.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Glad to see someone here is sane..."

**Effigy:** And as it burns, there is a sound in the room that no woven object should ever make. A shriek. Brief, high, and horribly human.

**Chandu:** *Roll SANLOSS, you three.*

**Chandu:** *ALSO.*

**Chandu:** *USE the Macros tab.*

**Chandu:** *It'll offer you a choice.*

**Chandu:** *Bryan, the shrieking catches you completely off-guard, but, as you pointed out, you can tell instantly that disposing of the thing was the right move.*

*Mac, what the fuck did you just see? This makes no fucking sense. You're more annoyed and confused than scared at all.*

*Giles, you take it worse. You're actually rattled by what you just saw.*

**Gen. Vang Hawj:** Vang watches the idol burn down to blackened knots in his hand, then drops the remains to the dirt floor and grinds them once under his heel. Only then does he look up at the party.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We heard a gunshot outside. We need to go check on the other two right now.

**Chandu:** *You all run over to peer out of the doorway. Two men lie dead by the crates now, and, as far as you can tell...*

**Chee Sawb:** It is Chee Sawb and one of your appointed escorts, one of his men.

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Maaan, he runs a tight ship in here."

**SSG Nuair A. al-Attar:** No one's making any moves. Nuair and Kuropas are eyeing everyone, and gazing back at you in case you have instructions.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** So a shootout didn't start? What the fuck just happened?

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "That doesn't bode too well for us..."

**Gen. Vang Hawj:** His English is blunt and imperfect. "These things-- better burn."

**Gen. Vang Hawj:** "Chee Sawb..." he looks at Sai Xee, who's shoved herself into a corner, obviously afraid. He says something to her in Laotian.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I nod. "Superstition. How you end up with Ming."

**Sai Xee:** "He-- says Chee Sawb was a liability. And... he thanks you for keeping hold of his crates."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** This genuinely feels like everyone is in on a joke I am not.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "And grasping at, uhh, how do you say... kandha."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "What the fuck do you mean by that?"

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** Do the MACV-SOG know about the unnatural part of the mission or not? I feel like we went over this last week

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I don't see a straw doll and think it's a haunted effigy you're just crazy.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** If it quacks like a duck...

**Chandu:** *They do. As remarked in the Discord post clearing it up, MACV-SOG are NRO Delta's equivalent for DG in this era and context (Vietnam War). Their knowledge however is limited to the following: Ming Yuan is some sort of sorcerer and with some cult called the Kuen Yuin. He must die, and you're the hitmen.*

**Chandu:** *Still, confusion is warranted.*

**Chandu:** *Skepticism is allowed as far as it doesn't compromise the mission.*

**Chandu:** *MOVING ON.*

**Gen. Vang Hawj:** "We talk outside." He kicks Touhue in the gut before stepping outside, sending him sprawling against a wall, still prone.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Well why did you kill him?"

**Gen. Vang Hawj:** "Traitor." He points at Chee Sawb. He says something more elaborate to Sai Xee.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm not even gonna challenge that. I'm just glad we have at least one guy to pathfind for us.

**Sai Xee:** "Chee Sawb deserted his forces while they were engaged with the Shan, coming here ahead of the shipment. General Vang was forced to forfeit the field and rush after him."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** Obviously I knew it was something like that to begin with but I'll act very surprised and disappointed anyway.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Wow..."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna ask if the guy he assigned us is a traitor or not.

**Gen. Vang Hawj:** He shakes his head, then speaks to Sai Xee.

**Sai Xee:** "Some yokel, he says. Still, the General will be able to provide proper support, as long as it is within his operational constraints."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Fine. Whatever. Today hasn't been the most fantastic day of my life."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "We really need to move up."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "In a way this was the best thing that could have happened."

**Chandu:** *By sheer luck, you've got the opportunity to actually come to an agreement with Vang Hawj. You can ask for intelligence and what you expect from him with Sai Xee as your translator.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Don't pretend you know anything about voodoo honkey."

**Chandu:** *Lay out your Qs, feel free to get as in depth as you want. We'll have a 10 minute break before he answers.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna ask about: the latest situation, any roads to avoid, recommendations on engaging the enemy at that spot if theres even any to begin with

**SSG Michael Giles:** What kinda firepower is the enemy packing?

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I make a mental note to explain to everyone here the SOP when it comes to the unnatural at some point. That is to say if anything 'looks weird' you destroy it and don't worry about the specifics in the same way you wouldn't worry about if a VC is a Trotskyist or Leninist.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** Also I'll ask Vang what this Ming guy is capable of and if there's any precautions we ought to take in advance.

**Chandu:** *Chee Sawb's and the other guy's bodies have been carried away, and the village returns to some semblance of normalcy.*

*As for your questions:*

*On the road: Vang Hawj can issue two escorts who'll guarantee your safe arrival to Wan Bok-aw through a rustic route. He commends you for your assistance facing the Shan ambush on the way here, and assures you that the path is well-known by his guys.*

*On the compound: as you'll come to see, he's relatively well-entrenched. At least well enough for him not to be able to assault the position outright with his forces-- this is why both he and Lung have resorted to irregular warfare, something they're both well-trained on.*

*On the enemy's firepower: For one, he remarks the lack of any body armor on both sides. You can expect small arms fire with no fire support, especially within the compound where they wouldn't risk or wouldn't be capable of using a mortar. Assault rifles, RPKs, a few scopes.*

*On Ming: noting the incredulity in your faces, he tries his best to explain that he is a sorcerer. Ambushes have been more common in locations where such effigies as the one he just set alight were found.*

**Chandu:** *On support (of course you asked): he can provide a diversionary force of 15 men to initiate a skirmish from the rainforest perimeter around the compound at a predetermined time or at a signal. They won't fight to win, but to get the enemy's direction if necessary. Though, of course, if you were to wreak enough havoc inside, the following confusion would facilitate a proper attempt.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** There's not really any other way than this or sapping our way in by making a tunnel we don't have so I wish them luck in getting out of that alive.

**Chandu:** *Note: the skirmish can begin from any direction you so choose. You can just tell the pointmen from where and what signal you'll be using to call the attack, and they'll carry the message down.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Can they hear our radio?

**Chandu:** *As noted before the session, your radios can transmit Morse code over several frequencies. The Hmong's radio equipment is rare, however...*

**Chandu:** 1

**Chandu:** *It's rackety and unreliable. You won't be able to transmit a proper message-- only a predetermined signal. Think a string of short beeps or a long beep.*

**Chandu:** *Anything else will get jumbled up.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We'll just transmit a single SOS then. 1 to 8 SOS signals, determining the angle of attack on a compass rose. Does that work?

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** With ten second intervals.

**Chandu:** *That'll work. However keep in mind that these guys will have to move around too. If you determine a direction from which to strike in advance, they'll be able to act immediately after the code goes through.*

**Chandu:** *Otherwise, they'll have to spend some time rotating.*

**Chandu:** *You can determine the direction of their approach during the reconnaissance stage.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Ok, then the "GO" signal would be just a simple long beep.

**Chandu:** *All is well. He has a couple more comments.*

**Chandu:** *By now, you'll get to Bok-aw past the afternoon. You're more likely to catch Lung on dinner with his lieutenants, though he'll be under a roof. He points at the M21 rifles. You'd have to drag him out or wait for an opening to get a clean shot from afar on him.*

**Chandu:** *On Ming: Nobody fucking knows what he looks like. He wishes you good luck, and to trust your instinct to determine whether a man is Chinese or not.*

**Chandu:** *Nor what he spends his time doing, other than having people kidnapped to do God knows what with them.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** Of course the idea is that he'll be dead before his identity is a problem for us.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I can smell the shark fin soup off a motherfucker...

**SSG Michael Giles:** Real Fu Manchu shit.

**Chandu:** *If that is all, we can proceed to the travel leg between Sa-pi-sai and Bok-aw.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Proceed.

**Chandu:** *On the trail, 1500R. Time to objective: 3H (arrival at dusk)*

**Chandu:** *The path to Bok-aw doesn't look like it was made so much as worn into the land by repetition. The jungle presses closer here... leaves, hanging branches, rootwork, the likes.*

**Chandu:** *You can tell that the two men leading the way have been here multiple times. They speak no English nor French, but you understand that they've observed the compound in the past and know how to make their way over discreetly.*

**Chandu:** *Nobody's talking much now. Discretion is paramount.*

**Chandu:** *The Hmong guides move ahead carefully, but confidently. Every now and then one of them lifts a hand and shifts the line a little, enough to avoid a punji stick trap or a root that would've sprained an ankle if hit wrong. It's not so slow going, what with the lack of crates and whatnot.*

**Chandu:** *Who's marching closest to the pointmen?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Me because these other pussies never would.

**Chandu:** *Obviously. You're a ways down the trail. You're scanning the treeline diligently.*

**Chandu:** *Roll Alertness, Mac, BLIND.*

**Chandu:** *You didn't register it as anything special at first-- just another knot of dark against the darker foliage. You caught the symmetry, though.*

**Chandu:** *Off the right side of the path, a little above eye level, something hangs from a bent branch, half-hidden behind broad leaves. You clock it as one of those effigies, quivering in the wind.*

**Chandu:** *It's perched up in a way that another few steps will carry the whole column past it.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Fuck!"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "TAKE COVER!"

**Chandu:** *Everyone drops down to the sides and enters total silence. You can each hear your own breathing.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I need to get closest to that fucking thing and set it on fire before bullets start raining.

**Chandu:** *Roll INT!*

**Chandu:** *Normal.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Failure** -> 68 (Rolling INT Target: 60%)

**Chandu:** *You'll have to crawl your way over. Describe the manner in which you do so.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Bryan, tell these guys we can divert the trail while we still can."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "They can see us."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I explain to them best as I can that we're in trouble and need to change course, gesticulating at the idol.

**Chandu:** *They look at you and seem to get the message. One of them rolls on his side and adjusts his bearing, and starts crawling uphill to the left.*

**Chandu:** *You can tell that this is gonna be a roundabout way, but you're in good company all the same.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'd rather take the long way than the ambush way.

**Chandu:** *Leaving the doll alone, then?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** It needs to go, right.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I have the brilliant idea of throwing some mud at it.

**Chandu:** *Hit Dexterity.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 7  
(Rolling DEX Target: 60%)

**Chandu:** *You know, as you roll on your side and focus your vision into it...*

**Chandu:** *You didn't clock it was such when you first saw it, but now you do. It's perched up in such an angle that the column effectively has not yet crossed its field of view.*

**Chandu:** *Your handful of mud knocks it off the tree. It lands...*

**Chandu:** 2

**Chandu:** *Face down, on the dirt.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm just going to leave it as is and move with the roundabout, setting it on fire may hurt its owner just as much as it hurts itself.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Mac snaps up a middle finger covered in mud.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Look at this."

**Chandu:** *All is well. You follow the prone Hmong guide uphill, crawling for some fifty meters. He then crouches up and looks around-- you're off the traversed trail, but it's safe to go ahead at a brisker pace.*

**Chandu:** *It's still a roundabout way, which adds 1 hour of travel to the compound. You'll be at the objective area at 1900R rather than 1800R.*

**Chandu:** *By 1900R, the sun has fallen.*

**Chandu:** *1900R*

**Chandu:** *You mirror the Hmong pointmen as they crouch lower, leading the group through a long bend. The jungle thins ahead into looser ground and the signs of forestry become obvious. The smell of woodsmoke and the sound of the Mekong River's calm flowing come to the forefront. The guides come to a stop in a position some 500 meters away from the village itself: you've arrived at Wan Bok-aw.*

**Chandu:** *Everyone, roll Search and Milsai (BLIND).*

**Chandu:** *From the first concealed overlook, Wan Bok-aw appears less like a single compound than a small world built around one center. The hilltop is dominated by a broad colonial villa, its roofline and upper walls catching what little moonlight there is. Lower down, the settlement spreads in layers, all pressed around older stone ruins that break up the center of the enclosure. Even at a distance, it is obvious this place grew over something older and more traditional.*

**Chandu:** *A wide outer palisade encircles the whole site, taking in fields, the worker hamlet, watercourses, and the lower ruins. Inside that, the inner fence encloses the real heart of the place. The effect is immediate: anything approaching from outside must first cross a broad, inhabited outer world before ever reaching the colonial-style villa and its inner core. The place is not elegant in design, but it is experienced.*

**Chandu:** *Much of the land in the compound is cultivated. Bands of pink poppies spread across the slope, and narrow irrigation streams cut through the lower ground.*

**Chandu:** *Right off the bat, you can determine the following: The rocky rise beyond the compound looks promising from a distance — high enough for command of much of the site — while the jungle edge where the team now lies offers concealment at the cost of restricted sightlines.*

**Chandu:** *For any further information, you'll have to start making moves. I'll reveal the landmarks and legend as you think.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna do a little drawing if you dont mind

**Chandu:** *We've still got an hour on the clock.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** If we circle around at the edge of the wall to this guard tower and take over it we have a clean shot at the front of the colonial mansion, which I assume is on a hill and otherwise no-shot from anywhere else

**Chandu:** *Mac, at your last comment: your Milsco rating is high enough for you to ascertain the rocky knoll to the west will most definitely command a better view over the compound.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** It's also really close up to the main entrance and far as fuck from the center isn't it.

**Chandu:** *If you were to set up on the furthest north side, sure. But it looks irregular enough to at least have an advantage at range over any would-be defenders from the main entrance.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We're not interested in clearing out the compound, we're just picking our guy and going.

**Chandu:** *And it's a bit of a climb, from where you're standing. Any attackers would first have to determine where a shooter might be, then work their way up under suppression.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Besides, gunfire coming outwards from the watchtower is less questionable than a rock.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Any chance of us swimming inside?

**Chandu:** *ALSO: For more details on any one landmark, ask away.*

**Chandu:** *As for swimming...*

**Chandu:** *You'd have to circle around the rocks and pass the trail west to get in the river. However...*

**Chandu:** *That is, indeed, the Mekong river.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I was thinking north.

**Chandu:** *It's not very dangerous, but it's a current-- then you've got the right idea.*

**Chandu:** *The current goes downstream from the north. That'd be an appropriate move, though from your somewhat elevated (yet precarious) position at ground level, you can guess that there must be guards at the river entrance too.*

**Chandu:** *Nothing that a bit of diving couldn't solve, if you're up for it.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We can stab them to death. Besides, our exit too, we wouldn't have to swim against the current when the north exit is right there.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We have ample hiding in the fields.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Maybe cover too if they are terraced.

**Chandu:** *There is also the matter of time. You got lucky with Vang Hawj's RELATIVELY early arrival. You have... let me run the clock...*

**Chandu:** *You have (ROUGHLY) a full two days worth to conduct recon, plan and execute your attack.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm thinking we get Kuropas to the tower as the main element moves in closer from the north towards the colonial house to storm it in case shit doesn't pan out.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Ruins look like a good spot to hold a fight.

**Chandu:** *Note: From here, the time to walk over to exfil would be about 14 hours. I'll adjust the time available taking that into account.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Probably filled with insane creepypasta shit though

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Haitian is so peculiar...

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Nolan had a M21 also right?

**Chandu:** *That's correct. You all know that an M21's effective range goes up to 700 meters in length.*

**Chandu:** *The map is to scale, you can use the measuring tool.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Would it be possible to get on the roof of the workshop, given that it's somewhat of an industrial deal and likely has a ladder up top?

**Chandu:** *That's a possibility. It's a 2-floor climb.*

**Chandu:** *I'll drop a few strategic options here, varying in degrees depending on how many MILSCI successes you get.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** It's currently 7PM right? We should start moving up there and see if we see anything extraordinary that would fuck up our plans.

**Chandu:** *Everyone gets to roll, even Kuropas.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Failure** -> 80 (Rolling MilitaryScience (Land) Target: 60%)

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** public or blind

**Chandu:** *Just leave it public. Not the end of the world for a fail, plus you still have time to apply some of the strategies not mentioned.*

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** SGT Lawrence Kuropas rolls **Failure** -> 79 (Rolling MilitaryScience (Land) Target: 40%)

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar rolls **Failure** -> 73 (Rolling MilitaryScience (Land) Target: 50%)

**SSG Michael Giles:** SSG Michael Giles rolls **Success** -> 45 (Rolling MilitaryScience (Land) Target: 50%)

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** can i contribute with an int roll

**Chandu:** *Go ahead.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** IA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Success** -> 70 (Rolling INT Target: 70%)

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** IA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Success** -> 31 (Rolling INT Target: 70%)

**Chandu:** *Bryan, a little adjustment on your skills: You should have a MILSCI rating of 20. Still, INT works for this one instance.*

**Chandu:** *You got two successes. One moment...*

**Chandu:** *Right. Common sense indicates that perching up at a vantage point and simply observing from concealment will earn you more actionable intel. Where to spot the targets, their daily movements and routines if any.*

**Chandu:** *Common sense also indicates that the closer you are, the easier it is to identify a target with a degree of certainty.*

**Chandu:** *Moreover: more personal avenues of intelligence-gathering would be to earn the (willing or unwilling) cooperation of a guard, or one of the villagers who is sure to inhabit the little sprawl in the west of the compound.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We could abduct and execute one.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm up for it.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** And feed them some bullshit with my SIGINT skills to divert some soldiers or something.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I already have a plan of how to execute the opening move of the attack itself but verily we are doing this next night

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** If you would like to hear it

**Chandu:** *As for ranged options, Nolan and Law do have a comment: the rocks, though they seem to be at about the edge of the M21's range from the villa where Lung Li Bao certainly lives, are a great firing position.*

**Chandu:** *The two seem confident about their ability to strike a shot at that distance, though the better the conditions, the more exposed the target is, and the more time they have to execute the shot, will all affect the result.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** The conditions are going to be shit and the weather may change, we'll use the rocks to collect intel but firing from them is a bridge too far for the M21 platform

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Maybe if we had a TAC50

**Chandu:** *Only good old binos.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** What I had in mind is we first take out the northern entrance QUIETLY, and then split into two. Kuropas and Bryan head towards the northwest tower to QUIETLY (or not) capture it. Us 3 will head to the workshop, Giles and Nolan get on the roof and I'll watch from 1st story.

As soon as the skirmish at the main gate begins and the other towers start shooting, Nolan takes out northeast and south tower guards. Kuropas holds fire for the main target to pop out and Giles cuts down whichever idiot manages to survive as soon as they exit out the courtyard

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Bryan can hopefully at least hold close quarters from Kuropas so he can do his job.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** This is subject to change via intel and thats why I don't want to talk about it any longer.

**Chandu:** *Noted. We can proceed with establishing a proper surveillance position up the hill unless anyone's got any more preliminary comments.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** At the end of the day we have every single gun we have enfilading the colonial house while the main gate skirmish takes place.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I think that might work.

**Chandu:** *In a rush, the rocky climb up the knoll would require an Athletics roll. You've plenty of time and can support each other, so it'll only consume one hour's worth of time getting up there.*

**Chandu:** *It is...*

**Chandu:** 2000R

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We're honestly not in that big of a hurry since we have a whole day ahead of us, I'm more interested in giving out the call for the auxiliary force

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** And abducting someone.

**Chandu:** *You set up a propa perimeter and conduct surveillance. Some right off the bat info on what you can see from here right NOW:*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I want to have Giles and Bryan make the fucker talk and take Kuropas or Nolan with me to pathfind up north safely.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** One needs to be on the watch obv.

**SSG Michael Giles:** Boy I'm going to get the Chang talkin'.

**Chandu:** *The main entrance seems to be guarded by some 8 guards this time of night. It remains to be seen whether that beefs up during daytime. You can see no weapon emplacements, and even*

*if there were any: they don't have a good firing position on you, besides trying their luck with potshots or suppression.*

**Chandu:** *The worker village seems quiet at night. You intuit that it's mostly civilians down there, fieldworkers and whatnot. Not much else to note for now, besides a guard or two making the rounds down the main road, maybe looking at the poppy field every once in a while.*

**Chandu:** *Bryan, roll History or Anthropology.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** IA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Failure** -> 74 (Rolling History Target: 60%)

**Chandu:** *The darkness doesn't provide much opportunity to make out the details from this vantage position, but as you look over the inner and outer ruins, you can guess they're of Buddhist make.*

**Chandu:** *No way to know what's in there without actually going inside, though, or hoping some daylight shines in enough for you to see something when dawn breaks.*

**Chandu:** *Around the villa lie the Outbuildings and the Barracks. - The barracks are as you would expect, mostly dormant. Four guards do the rounds, stopping along the way for a smoke or some chitchat.- You can see a truck peeping its nose out from a garage in the outbuildings. ONE of you roll INT.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** IA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Success** -> 54 (Rolling INT Target: 70%)

**Chandu:** *The truck and the overall layout somewhat confirm your initial suspicions: the outbuildings must be where the Lung's heroin no. 1 (morphine base) harvested from the field poppies is processed, packed and loaded for transport.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Does the workshop roof have a shot on the truck? Fairly certain the LMG could take care of it if it was used for escape.

**Chandu:** *The workshop north of the villa: it looks more private than the rest of the buildings. First, to answer that question: it does. The workshop's roof has a clear firing lane on both the villa's courtyard and the garage where the truck is.*

**Chandu:** *Additionally, I'm making a hidden roll for one of you...*

**MSG Cillian F. MacAllister:** 1

**Chandu:** *Mac.*

**Chandu:** *As you look over the workshop through your binoculars, you'd swear the hairs at the back of your neck stand up. The reason for it becomes obvious after you squint and center your view on the window overlooking the courtyard.*

**Chandu:** *There is an effigy perched up above it.*

**Chandu:** *It's almost as if it was placed there as a sentry, now that you have some manner of indication as to how these things work.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Is it looking at me?

**Chandu:** *No way. It's just facing south towards the courtyard.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We need to find more of these things. That one is effectively meaningless as we can take it out with zero difficulty.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We don't intend to walk in front of it.

**Chandu:** *Observation in shifts will do the job, daylight will prove useful too.*

**Chandu:** *Finally...*

**Chandu:** *The villa. It's by far the most striking building in the compound. It's built in a French-colonial style, all of you can tell. What's more noteworthy is that the courtyard is active. That's what the light there is about.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I've been here long enough to know that style. How well can it resist 7.62x51?

**Chandu:** *It's almost certainly made with brickwork, though the material can vary. You reckon the 60 can mow down a wall with some continuous fire, but you'd have to guess where to shoot at for it to be effective beyond suppression and shock.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Not ideal if we reveal our position above the roof, then.

**Chandu:** *Furthermore, on the villa: Some twenty men seem to be having a gathering there. Nolan and Law, looking through their scopes, can positively ID Lung Li Bao hanging out with them from here.*

**Chandu:** *This very moment, even.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** So we counted 30?

**Chandu:** *In total, the night detail amounts to:*

*- 8 (TS)*

*- 2 (WV)*

*- 4 (BK)*

*You can only guess how many guys are up in the other watchtowers. You can see the lights are on inside, but no one's hanging around at ground level.*

**Chandu:** *As for the gathering, it's about 20, yes.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** No weapon emplacements right

**Chandu:** *That's correct. At least from the watchtowers, as visible at this moment.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We are outnumbered 1:8 and likely more, we are doing the objective and extracting immediately.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I have no further comments to issue as of now.

**Chandu:** *You guys are welcome to shoot the shit (discuss) right now. We can pass a couple of time segments while we make time to end the session.*

**Chandu:** *Further planning will be done over the week in Discord, and the plan's execution will be next week.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'd like to get to right before the attack in this session.

**Chandu:** *Are you scoping it out for an entire day, up until tomorrow nighttime?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Not me personally also we need to rest up

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** 7/24 watch with shifts we should all be rested by we go in

**Chandu:** *That's the way to do it. In shifts, you should be good to strike at a time of your convenience.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We're gonna attack precisely at the end of civil twilight without wasting any more time with waiting (or if a better opportunity presents itself which I doubt)

**Chandu:** *Roger That. We'll pass 24 hours in observation and then you can work out when, where, and in what manner you want to attack.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Also we need to nab a villager and find a reliable path up to the north.

**Chandu:** *24 hours of observation will leave you with 7 hours to execute whatever plan you'll concoct, which should be plenty to move around and move in. Advancing...*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I got an idea. Attack a bit late to disrupt the REM sleep of the day shift? Could be an upper hand which we desperately need.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Could make a worlds difference a guy running in a daze vs. one whos still awake with a gun.

**Chandu:** *First, the activity by day. Lung Li Bao being positively ID'd by the snipers, finding him among a crowd and following is simple work.*

*Lung Li Bao rarely shows himself by day, but careful observation through the villa's windows indicate movement to and from some ground-floor room. The team's MILSCI stack lets you intuit that his office might be there.*

**Chandu:**  $\Delta$  *Around 3 p.m., a truck arrives at the compound to collect processed opium. Lung Li Bao emerges from the villa to examine the shipment. The truck then drives down the dirt track some 500 meters through the jungle to a dock barely visible from here on the banks of the Mekong.*

**Chandu:**  $\Delta$  *In the evening, Lung Li Bao and his lieutenants gather on the terrace for cigarettes before dinner.*

**Chandu:**  $\Delta$  *Lung Li Bao's dinner gives way to drinking and carousing with his cronies for hours.*

**Chandu:** *As for Ming Yuan...*

**Chandu:** *Everyone gets a single SEARCH roll.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 14  
(Rolling Search Target: 20%)

**SSG Michael Giles:** SSG Michael Giles rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 99 (Rolling Search Target: 20%)

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** SGT Lawrence Kuropas rolls **Failure** -> 89 (Rolling Search Target: 70%)

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar rolls **Success** -> 54 (Rolling Search Target: 60%)

**Chandu:** *Bryan, hit it.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** IA Bryan Carlyle rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 77 (Rolling Search Target: 60%)

**Chandu:** *With two successes out of five (best result), you ascertain the following.*

**Chandu:** *Throughout the day, looking over the worker village and the fields adjacent to it, you notice plentiful civilian traffic. Tending to the field, carrying supplies, working overall, whatever.*

**Chandu:** 1

**Chandu:** *Only one thing perks up any attention: some individual wearing an endogenous straw farmer's hat seems to be lounging in a hammock all day as the others work.*

**Chandu:** *Nobody approaches him.*

**Chandu:** *No positive ID from here.*

**Chandu:** *At night, he's not there.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm still with the opinion that if we attack deep into the night with a delay after the front end wave goes in everyone will rush to the front gate for defense rather than hunkering down in the colonial house which is the worst outcome.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Plus you can't see who's inside the watchtowers meaning any shots outgoing from there will be extremely difficult to ID

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** About the other guy... well for the lack of an explanation we are going where it's taking us.

**Chandu:** *There's one more detail throughout today, specifically.*

**Chandu:** *At around 1500R, a small but decently sized boat floats inside down the Mekong. It's allowed passage without question.*

**Chandu:** *The guys on it don't seem native, they don't make any effort to cover up their identities either.*

**Chandu:** *They pull up and ground the boat closest to the village. Workers from the outbuildings start lugging brown bales of morphine base over there.*

**Chandu:** *The men load it up, and leave the boat there. They leave two of their own guys watching over the boat as the other 4 rest either in the village or hang out with the rest at the villa.*

**Chandu:** *Bryan, being CIA, you get a HUMINT or History roll.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** IA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Failure** -> 94 (Rolling HUMINT Target: 70%)

**Chandu:** *One thing's clear: they're not from here, and they're staying the night.*

**Chandu:** *That's as far as we'll go for this session. I'll post the logs so you can compile intel off them and deliberate over the week.*

**Chandu:** *Any comments before concluding?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** If they are our guys, at this point, I have no qualms about cutting them down together with the rest.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Just putting that out in case blondie cares.

**SSG Michael Giles:** Are they white or some sort of Asian?

**SSG Michael Giles:** Can we tell?

**Chandu:** *They're wholly Southeast Asian. Since you spoke with Vang Hawj, you get an extra tidbit: the guy is definitely in with the CIA on the heroin part operation, but certainly not Lung's heroin operation.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Everyone is dying tonight.

**Chandu:** *That'll be all for tonite. THANKS FOR PLAYING...*

## JP SESSION 3

May 15, 2026

June 13, 1968 - June 14, 1968

**Chandu:** *Wan Bok-aw, Jun 13, 1968, 2300R*

**Chandu:** *Without further ado, you've resolved to swimming in through the river entrance. As far as you remember it from the night before, there were at most three guys casually walking back and forth the walkbridge up top every now and again.*

**Chandu:** *You may all hit a SWIM roll at +10% from being in relative proximity with each other, and the softness of the current.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 23 (Rolling Swim Target: 50%)

**Chandu:** *Make it public.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** IA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Success** -> 4 (Rolling Swim Target: 20%)

**SSG Michael Giles:** SSG Michael Giles rolls **Success** -> 20 (Rolling Swim Target: 70% (60%+10%))

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar rolls **Failure** -> 61 (Rolling Swim Target: 20%)

**Chandu:** *Although Nuair is having trouble with his kit, the rest of you easily keep ahold of him and keep him from floating off.*

**Chandu:** 2

**Chandu:** *You chose a good moment to make your entrance. There doesn't seem to be anyone actively watching the water from the walkway, but...*

**Chandu:** *Two guys, smoking and chatting.*

**Chandu:** *You don't need to understand them. They're not paying attention.*

**Chandu:** *You've made it past the river gate, and can choose to keep floating downriver and get off the water at a place of your convenience.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Do we need further rolls at this point, we could get off near the watchtower.

**Chandu:** *Rolls unnecessary. You can stop by a patch of poppies, using them as concealment.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I think I could get in there and plant the satchel.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** This river is loud as fuck.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** They can't hear us.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** No way.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Anyone at the foot of the watchtower?

**Chandu:** *Approaching unannounced and unspotted, yes, you can easily tell...*

**Shan Militia:** Two men, unattentive as well. The night shift...

**Chandu:** *And up top:*

**Shan Militia:** One singular individual, looking out towards the rainforest.

**Chandu:** *You can choose your approach. This part seems really straightforward-- they seem to be casually chatting over some bullshit in Laotian which you can't understand.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm going to make some "suffering monkey" noises to draw them towards here and let these three stab them to death, I'll go up top and kill the guy. We don't need to actually waste our charge here now.

**Chandu:** *You can hit....*

**Chandu:** *Hit a Luck roll.*

**Chandu:** 64

**Chandu:** *You make some noises, and they stop chatting. They both go quiet, look at each other, then approach the bush together.*

**Chandu:** *Guy up top is unphazed.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Woook- woook- woooooo-"

**Shan Militia:** Shan Militia rolls **Failure** -> 21 (Rolling Search Target: 20%)

**Shan Militia:** Shan Militia rolls **Failure** -> 46 (Rolling Search Target: 20%)

**Shan Militia:** They legitimately cannot see shit. You are completely hidden.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** They can handle it. I'll move ahead.

**Chandu:** *Any two of you, roll Melee with a +40% bonus.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Nuair remains ready to strike with his knife.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar rolls **Success** -> 15 (Rolling Melee Weapons Target: 70%)

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I'll go out and stab the one on the left.

**SSG Michael Giles:** SSG Michael Giles rolls **Success** -> 28 (Rolling Melee Weapons Target: 70% (30%+40%))

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** IA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Success** -> 50 (Rolling Melee Weapons Target: 50%)

**Chandu:** *This works.*

**Shan Militia:** ////////////////////////////////////// Half the face is sliced open from a long, deep and brutal slash. Starting above the ear, to the neck.

**Shan Militia:** ////////////////////////////////////// The attack punches through the skull. Eyes roll back as the opposition faints from the shock.

**Chandu:** *Nuair. He's still alive, but he's writhing on the floor, reaching for his throat.*

**Chandu:** *He's not making any considerable noise besides gurgling, which is washed out by the river itself.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I'll finish him.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Slit his throat clean on the ground.

**Shan Militia:** You slide the blade across his carotid, then stab clean through his trachea. He stops moving, and your hands are full of blood.

**Chandu:** *Mac, your move.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm getting up there and putting a piano wire around his neck, no one should see any blood splattered.

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles will be dragging one of the corpses into the poppies.

**MSG Cillian F. MacAllister:** Your target is unaware, and being next to the river, your footsteps up the stairs are muted. You can roll Unarmed at a +40%.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** Likewise, guessing one of the shrubs should hide him well enough.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** That's a 100%.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 20 (Rolling Unarmed Combat Target: 60%)

**Shan Militia:** Unless this guy rolls a 1, he's dead.

**Shan Militia:** Shan Militia rolls **Failure** -> 46 (Rolling STR Target: 45%)

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Cillian does a loop around the guys neck and lifts his small frame up on his back until he stops moving.

**Chandu:** *Exactly the way I was describing it. He writhes helplessly before coming to a stop.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Are there guards at the other end of the river? We could just toss them in.

**Chandu:** *You don't see any lights from patrols or otherwise across the field. Returning to wide view...*

**Chandu:** *You can, indeed, toss them in the river.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I don't want them to wash up against security detail

**Chandu:** *If you follow the track to the south, you'll remember that there is a similar gate as the one you just crossed down there.*

**Chandu:** *Choose whether you want to lug them into the water or leave them in the field right there.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Let's just lug them in while we can, after searching them for keys. I don't expect to find a radio.

**Chandu:** *You run their pockets. They've no such things on them, either option.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Let's move on. I'm planning to plant the charges below the barracks if we somehow come across their foundations.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Or the workshop, whichever.

**Chandu:** *Remember that there's the inner perimeter fence prior to approaching the villa and barracks. Which route are you taking?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Floating down the river to connect via underground from southern ruins.

**Chandu:** *You enter the river again, floating on the surface. You're not doing this under pressure this time, so the float down is leisurely besides keeping yourselves afloat with your equipment on.*

**Chandu:** *You hear your survival radios. A very low, muted sound-- two clicks. The signal that Kuropas can see you from up top.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Affirm.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Let's get in there.

**Chandu:** *You crawl up the shore and make your way into the delapidated construction that is the OUTER RUIN.*

**Chandu:** *Carlyle reasoned that this structure must be connected with the other through an underground passage. As such, it's not a question of whether you find it, but a question of how long it'll take for you to do so.*

**Chandu:** *Highest SEARCH rolls, public.*

**Chandu:** *Those are Carlyle and Nuair.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** IA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Success** -> 18 (Rolling Search Target: 60%)

**Chandu:** **Successful.** *You lift a thicket of bushes and reveal an underground passage, hidden from plain view, within ten minutes.*

**Chandu:** **LOADING...**

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I let out an impressed whistle at my own ingenuity.

**Chandu:** *It smells outdoorsy, of course-- that wet dirt you could smell by the Mekong's bankline. It doesn't stink of death or decrepitness as pop culture media would have you believe back in the cinema.*

**Chandu:** *You can see lanterns lighting the way around some sort of pool or pond. This all was obviously constructed by humans.*

**Chandu:** *You may switch to your weapon states (PRIMARY) and begin moving.... in a moment.*

**Chandu:** *Alright. Nuair is pointman.*

**Chandu:** *You're not in any immediate danger, decide how far you're going and call your turn.*

**Chandu:** *Or so you think, at least.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I move forward towards the corner until I see someone or reach it.

**Chandu:** *Mac, you're up.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I am disoriented as shit why cant I see anyone else

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna cover the opposite corner of Nolan.

**Chandu:** *All clear, as far as you can tell.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Tripwire?

**Chandu:** *...None.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Skip.

**Chandu:** *Giles.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** This room is fucking huge.

**SSG Michael Giles:** Pushing behind Naur

**Chandu:** *Carlyle, your go.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I'll stack up behind Mac in that case.

**Chandu:** *Excellent. New round.*

**Chandu:** *The path goes left and right here.*

**Chandu:** *Otherwise, into the pool. Maybe it's time to continue that river swim.*

**Chandu:** *It's you guys' choice. You can talk to each other.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Nuair signals to MacAllister to split up.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm signalling them to not go into the water.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I'm going right.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I check for any traps or hiding spots as I walk.

**Chandu:** *Some structure to your right. Seems to be a decrepit icon. Of what, you can't tell-- maybe Buddha?*

**Chandu:** *Hit an ALERTNESS roll.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar rolls **Failure** -> 52 (Rolling Alertness Target: 50%)

**Chandu:** *Business as usual. You can continue.*

**Chandu:** *Call your turn when you're done.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** This far is enough.

**Chandu:** *Mac.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm rounding the corner as well

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** No rolls?

**Chandu:** *None.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Skip.

**Chandu:** *Giles, your turn.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Round the corner to the right and then plant myself behind a pillar near Naur.

**Chandu:** *You jog up to the pillar and get under the lamp. Maybe you registered it at first, maybe you didn't-- but the fire is almost blood red.*

**Chandu:** *It doesn't seem to be burning particularly hotter than a normal lamp would. It must be some sort of kindling they put on it, you reason.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles mutters "This is some Fu Manchu shit," to himself.

**SSG Michael Giles:** done

**Chandu:** *Carlyle.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I'll continue to follow Mac's path.

**Chandu:** *You can move up ahead without anything to interrupt you. You take a second to gaze over the murals, though. Though degraded, they are faithful recreations of Buddhist legends. You wonder if any archaeologists have found their way here yet...*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I peek right.

**Chandu:** *You're moving methodically, so you get a +20% on your ALERTNESS roll here.*

**Chandu:** *Hit it.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar rolls **Failure** -> 68 (Rolling Alertness Target: 50%)

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** **Success**

**Chandu:** *That's a success. Before you reach the corner, you stop. You look on down, near your boot.*

**Chandu:** *Right where you stop... as expected from such places, a tripwire is brushing against you.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I calmly back off.

**Chandu:** *It's low enough that you can step over it. You can also follow the wire with your eyes and see the payload.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I look around to see if there's a secondary trap.

**Chandu:** *You can't see any from here, just the one wire in front of you.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I carefully walk over the wire to defuse the payload.

**Chandu:** *You hop over. To your right is a Soviet grenade, wire tied to the pin, which has been left half-pulled.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "Handy motherfuckers, eh?"

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Demolition roll?

**Chandu:** *I'd say this is a simple enough matter to resolve by... that's right.*

**Chandu:** *Hit it, no modifiers.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar rolls **Success** -> 7 (Rolling Demolitions Target: 40%)

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Free grenade.

**Chandu:** *You carefully slide the pin back on. You have a hand grenade available to you now-- feel free to add it to your inventory manually.*

**Chandu:** *That's your turn.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I heard him speak. I'm gonna check this corner for traps first before stacking up against it for partial and peeking north.

**Chandu:** *Being able to move up ahead at your leisure, and now possessing the knowledge that there are indeed traps here, will allow you to get through this patch without a roll.*

**Chandu:** *There is no wire here.*

**Chandu:** *You peek around the corner, I intuit. Some distance ahead, you see a lump.*

**Shan Militia:** It looks like a dead man.

**Chandu:** *He's just splattered on the floor, like he was shot.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Most likely an execution. Is this where they take 'em to do it?

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Any guns nearby?

**Chandu:** *Nothing. They killed him and left nothing that you can see around, at least from here.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Adds up. Done.

**Chandu:** *You'll have to get closer for a better examination.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles follows behind but stacks behind the pillar and looks towards the north.

**Chandu:** *You look northwards, and notice nothing as lit by the red light sources.*

**Chandu:** *You're safe to stay here. Call it?*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Yep.

**SSG Michael Giles:** Naur is pointman after all.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I'm following Mac.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** Anything I can see here?

**Chandu:** *You stack up without interruptions. You can also see the corpse from here, but that's not saying much.*

**Chandu:** *Is that all for this turn?*

**Chandu:** *We proceed.*

**Chandu:** *NUAIR!!!!*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** There ought to be some shit here.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** But it's dark as hell.

**Chandu:** *You can see no further tripwires this way. You can see, however, the signs of rocky rubble up ahead.*

**Chandu:** *You can choose to continue this way off the main path if you wish.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Decisions, decisions.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I move east.

**Chandu:** *You confirm the presence of a possible cave collapse. Nothing seems to be actively breaking down or creaking.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna move towards that corner while checking for tripwires.

**Chandu:** *You can move up ahead. Roll ALERTNESS about midway.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** No bonus?

**Chandu:** *No bonus. You'll come to find that there are no traps for you to step on-- it's about further identifying factors for the body as you close in.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Failure** -> 80 (Rolling Alertness Target: 60%)

**Chandu:** *It's just another corpse from here. However, you can't see any blood pooled under it.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Then that's not an execution. A sole body killed elsewhere left here?

**Chandu:** *Up to you to find out. Next turn.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles is going to stack up behind Nuair but cover the back.

**Chandu:** *You do so. No surprises here.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I continue to follow Mac's lead.

**Chandu:** *Moving on*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar rolls **Success** -> 37 (Rolling Alertness Target: 50%)

**Chandu:** *Rather than a collapse, this path looks like it was dug through by men. You observe no movement, human or otherwise, as far as your flashlight allows you to see.*

**Chandu:** *You can still move a little ways further within your turn.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Anything visible inside?

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** To my left?

**Chandu:** *Nothing visible, besides the obvious opening.*

**Chandu:** *It's dark.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm just gonna go ahead and peek that corner.

**Chandu:** *You shine your light through as far as you can down the hallway. It's devoid of activity.*

**Chandu:** *You're close enough to the corpse to examine it.*

**Chandu:** *Firstly: the death seems to have been relatively recent-- maybe this morning. As such, the corpse shows no outward signs of decomposition besides skin decoloration. You're no expert, but you can tell that he's got no blood in it. It's as if he'd dried up completely.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** If it's dead that's good enough. Next.

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles pushes up behind Nuair. Same position of covering his six.

**Chandu:** *You come up to him, and feel the wind blowing softly from the room to your right.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I stack up on the corner.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "You wanna hold my hand too?"

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Yes."

**Chandu:** *Uneventful. You observe the same on the corpse as Mac did when he walked past...*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I walk to the corner carefully looking for traps.

**Chandu:** *You needn't roll. As you peek your head out of the opening, having watched for tripwires, you observe an object you've come to know in the past two days.*

**Chandu:** *Its silhouette is hanging up on the ceiling, looking down the corridor towards the light.*

**Chandu:** *As if attentively watching for trespassers.*

**Chandu:** *You're in its blind spot still.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I suppress any fear I have.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I signal for the brother to follow.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Can I estimate where we are right now.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Still in the ruins?

**Chandu:** *You can estimate you're about halfway through the path into the inner ruins.*

**Chandu:** *The way, of course, being north.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm getting a bit bored stacking against seemingly nothing so I want to quickly cover this wing.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** If the fucking retard next to me would be so kind as to do something else.

**Chandu:** *A side corridor. You can see nothing.*

**Chandu:** *It does continue northward.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** South of me

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Is that a door or just a crevice

**Chandu:** *A dent in the wall, not a path.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** West the path ends right.

**Chandu:** *That's right. Just a wall.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna draw my knife and throw it against whoever I see first. This shit looks too cramped for a rifle anyway.

**Chandu:** *That will work. You can move a little further up into the corridor.*

**Chandu:** *The wall to the left seems to have collapsed under the weight of time... yadda yadda.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles goes to Nuair, but not before peeking at the room to the left with a flashlight.

**Chandu:** *You see a table. On top of it, you notice the conspicuous streaks of something having been drawn across the surface.*

**Chandu:** *Nothing else of interest.*

**Chandu:** *There's been no risk factors besides a singular trap and and effigy for however long you've been here. We can expedite the rest of the way with longer movements.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Onwards we go.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** did mac go to the left corridor

**Chandu:** *That's right.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I'll cover him from here.

**Chandu:** *Covering the way here? Be aware You can't precisely shoot down range with him on the way.*

**Chandu:** *Next... LONGER MOVEMENTS.*

**Chandu:** *You've reached the final stretch, Nuair, and you're confident that there are no tripwires waiting for you at this specific corner.*

**Chandu:** *That's good enough.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** This room is too expansive, tac wielding my M1911

**Chandu:** *Proceed.*

**Chandu:** *Up on your left, you come to notice something.*

**Chandu:** *As you step within visual range, it's like something in the wind shifted. Two lamps, similar to the ones outside, come alive.*

**Chandu:** *No movements, otherwise. You can see the edge of what appears to be a sort of altar.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Are they just reflecting the lights off our fucking flashlights?

**Chandu:** *No. You shine the light back behind you-- the lamps are emitting the lights themselves.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Any more of those effigies here?

**Chandu:** *None. You can see what's on top of the altar, however-- it's a mummified body.*

**Chandu:** *A real life mummy. This would surely be interesting to some scholar-- but still, as a layman, you can't help but wonder why the fuck there'd be a mummy here.*

**Chandu:** *It seems well-preserved, and it wears no clothing.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Whatever. The next tight corridor seems like the perfect place to put tripwire.

**Chandu:** *You can move up to it.*

**Chandu:** *There is no wire. You can proceed to the next corner uninterrupted.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna swap to main... dex?

**Chandu:** *Not a problem if you switch straight up-- it won't consume your turn. You are taking your time here.*

**Chandu:** *As you peek to the left and to the right, as if you were to cross the street, you see...*

**Chandu:** *From this angle, you see it clearly. It's hanging up top, by that pillar's lamp.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** What's to north

**Chandu:** *End of the road, no access upstairs. If the structure is symmetrical, it'll converge to the east.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Makes sense. Is that it?

**Chandu:** *That's it for now.*

**Chandu:** *Giles, you can move up as far as Nuair.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Done,

**Chandu:** *You notice nothing out of the ordinary. Similarly, Carlyle, you can follow Mac's footsteps while covering the back.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** That's what I do then.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Routine checks for traps and moving up to the corner.

**Chandu:** *Hit an INT roll mid-jog.*

**Chandu:** *No mods.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar rolls **Success** -> 21 (Rolling INT Target: 55%)

**SSG Nuair A. al-Attar:** About this far in, you notice Mac's light shining on the effigy up ahead.

**SSG Nuair A. al-Attar:** Were you to run up to the corner, you'd come into its viewrange.

**SSG Nuair A. al-Attar:** You can't proceed without stepping into it unless it is otherwise disrupted. What's the move?

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Is communicating free? I'm just telling him to hold.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** It's the one I see far ahead in the corridor right?

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Not to my right.

**Chandu:** *It is. Let's say you can see each other's lights as you're looking at the same spot. Yes, to your left down the corridor.*

**Chandu:** *You know to hold.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna get Carlyle to boost me up to the effigy and snatch the thing into his patrol cap.

**Chandu:** *That's doable. We can move him up.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I have no interest in rubbing this thing. I'll just leave it face down on the floor.

**Chandu:** *You pull it down from its hanging spot, flinging it to the front in order to avoid its "gaze". It lands face-down, as you're under no pressure at the moment.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Is it "wall" all the way across here?

**Chandu:** *Those are all walls. There's a break in it just up ahead, about the midpoint where Nuair is across from you.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna peek from partial.

**Chandu:** *You lean to your right, and can see the faint glow of moonlight coming in from a passage.*

**Chandu:** *You've found the exit upwards.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Can we step up and get the fuck outta here one two? No more rooms right.

**Chandu:** *Indeed, you can. You can expediently rally the team up and move right away.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Let's move.

**Chandu:** *You're now in the inner compound, by the looks of it. Remaining in cover, you can see the lights coming from the villa.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Did we fucking miss the barracks foundations?

**Chandu:** *The process of walking through the ruins consumed ONE HOUR. One moment.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** refreshing to see shit

**Chandu:** *From here, you can estimate where the foundations for THIS barracks building (blast area will overlap with the perimeter checkpoint here) is.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We can't plant it in the tunnel?

**Chandu:** *Now, you can plant the satchel charge WITHIN that hour you just spent. It's a simple process.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I called out this process when we were at the watchtower so it's legal.

**Chandu:** *Yes, we remember. Having been at both ends of the ruins, you can set the charge at the midsection, veering to the west. You can detonate it on command.*

**Chandu:** *However, it's something to mind if your exfiltration will follow the same route.*

**Chandu:** *It's done.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I was thinking of just wheeling out from whichever direction, not planning to go back into the tunnels.

**Chandu:** *Do you intend to plant the satchel charge under this third barracks building?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** The other one

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Sleepy ones

**Chandu:** *The ruin path isn't wide enough to tunnel under those. It goes as such:*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Ok I get it no need to reiterate.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Let's move into the villa- the exit will be dynamic anyhow.

**Chandu:** *You'll approach from the southeastern corner.*

**Chandu:** *LOADING...*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We're going to check for his office and then go up to his room. Obviously it couldn't be anywhere but the top floor...

**Chandu:** *Luckily for you, it's a single-floor villa. The previously-stated terrace is the entrance at ground floor.*

**Chandu:** *Give me two minutes.*

**Chandu:** *WE'RE UP.*

**Chandu:** *The villa looks as opulent besides the rest of the structures in the compound as it did from the observation spot.*

**Chandu:** *You've approached from the corner closest to the spot you emerged from in the ruins.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna approach the closest window and peer in.

**Chandu:** *It's started. Nuair is first to move.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I'm gonna approach the closest window and peer in.

**Chandu:** *You can see a bathroom door, on inside.*

**Chandu:** *A bathtub and sink. Wow. Running water?*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Powered by God

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I keep moving.

**Chandu:** *Carry on. You can still move.*

**Chandu:** *What you're going to see here is a typewriter.*

**Chandu:** *That is Lung's office. You can see inside.*

**Chandu:** *It's empty, however. It's the middle of the night after all.*

**Chandu:** *Next turn is up.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna tail him and try to pry the window open with my knife.

**Chandu:** *I think Stealth will suffice for this one. Hit it blind.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Consider the bonuses

**Chandu:** *Of course.*

**Chandu:** *You pry the window open, finding the locking mechanism and slowly moving it aside without making much of a sound. You push it aside, opening the way.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Everyone gets inside. I'm gonna aid Bryan in searching the room.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Skip.

**SSG Michael Giles:** whoops

**Chandu:** *Everyone can follow on inside.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** As Giles enters I'm going to signal him to put his ear against the door and look through the hole.

**SSG Michael Giles:** I folloo.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Yo GM pause.

**Chandu:** *We're back at the top. What're you trying to do here?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I signalled Giles to go do that thing against the door and Bryan is presumably searching the room no.

**SSG Michael Giles:** Yea I'm doing it.

**Chandu:** *That's doable. Giles, you're free to move up. Carlyle, hit a SEARCH roll.*

**Chandu:** *As for Mac and Nuair, what're you up to for the next thirty second to a minute?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm helping Bryan.

**Chandu:** *He's assisted. It'll be taken into account as a +20%.SEARCH, PUBLIC.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I'm also searching the room.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** IA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Success** -> 39 (Rolling Search Target: 60%)

**Chandu:** *Giles, you slowly put your ear to the door and hear the sound of distant chattering. It sounds like five to six grown men having a quiet chat.*

**Chandu:** *They're intentionally being quiet, you gather.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** I could toss it open and let it rip but I'll defer to command.

**Chandu:** *Mac, Bryan, Nolan. You find, prying Lung's desk open, a ledger of transactions. A flipthrough, though you know no Laotian, indicates that Lung deals with men who have... Italian? Names.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** It's always the fucking wops...

**Chandu:** *You'll have to bring this back with you to have it translated and analyzed. Add it to your inventory as TRANSACTION LEDGER.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm keeping it.

**Chandu:** *You do that. Besides that, you can find multiple small bales of morphine base in the cabinets. You know that this kind isn't snorted, but smoked.*

**Chandu:** *Anything you'd like to do about that before moving on?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** My instincts tell me that if this oversized room in a one story villa is dedicated to the office the next biggest one, the master bedroom, must be on the opposite side with the most window coverage.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I suggest we sneak out and go the other side out the back.

**Chandu:** *Nuair, your turn to move.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Actually that shit wasn't a suggestion that was an order.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I remembered we are in the army

**Chandu:** *Out the window!*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I also suggest that we have two people go in that way and two via this door.

**Chandu:** *Up to you guys. Next turn.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We have another fight ahead of us besides this, we need to get to him and kill him in his sleep.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna sneak across the whole breadth of the back, we already saw it was empty

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Keeping low at windows to not be seen.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Do I keep going?

**Chandu:** *That's the laundry room. You can wait here for the others, as you can hear low chatter up ahead.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Of course, that's better. Skip.

**SSG Michael Giles:** Bring me to my master.

**Chandu:** *You can move!*

**Chandu:** *You can stack up by Mac.*

**Chandu:** *NEXT IS CARLYLE LET'S GO*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I signal everyone to come hold against me, I have an idea.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** where is blackie

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** Condition Changes Aiming

**Chandu:** *He stacked up and hit an aim forward.*

**Chandu:** *New round new turns, speak as you will and come up with what you're gonna do.*

**Chandu:** *Low, sporadic chatter up ahead still.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna sneak past this window and drop on the ground next to this veranda, using my makeup mirror I'm gonna see who's on it.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** One that's standard issue by the way.

**Chandu:** *We were wondering. Nuair's turn can go after yours, since you are leading this specific action.*

**Chandu:** *You see them. Sitting on chairs, smoking and talking normally, in a quiet tone.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Is the veranda high enough to crawl past or under?

**Shan Militia:** "Ngo thac phin la..."

**Chandu:** *The place doesn't have crawlspace, no. The only way through is to vault over the railing.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Can I crawl past though.

**Chandu:** *Oh, that's what you meant. You indeed can.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We're all doing that.

**Chandu:** *We can expedite that action. I'm moving the tokens.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** My turn over?

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm signalling them to go peek the windows.

**Chandu:** *Next turn it is.*

**Chandu:** *Nuair is up.*

**Chandu:** *Bathroom, light off. Window pryable.*

**Chandu:** *Kitchen, light on-- no one inside, but a pot with rice is on the stove.*

**Chandu:** *It's simmering.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Perhaps I can slightly pry open the window before man comes back.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We're looking for the masters bedroom. No need.

**Chandu:** *Roll INT, Nuair.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar rolls **Failure** -> 92 (Rolling INT Target: 55%)

**Chandu:** *Although it seemed to whizz your mind at the moment, the bathroom you looked into at the very beginning, before you went into the office...*

**Chandu:** *The adjacent bedroom had its curtains drawn.*

**Chandu:** *No one took a peek inside. You can quickly communicate this to the rest of the team.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I signal to backtrack.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna swallow my pride and just roll with it.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Can we make it there in one turn?

**Chandu:** *One of you is gonna roll Stealth this time around... following the turn order, 1 is Giles, 4 is Mac.*

**Chandu:** 2

**Chandu:** *Carlyle, roll STEALTH.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** IA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Failure** -> 31 (Rolling Stealth Target: 10%)

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** sheeiiiit no bonuses

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** ?

**Chandu:** *Coincidentally, it's a +20%, from environmental conditions. Though his pants snag on a rogue branch, it doesn't perk up the guards' attention.*

**Chandu:** *WE ARE TELEPORTING TWO MINUTES INTO THE FUTURE.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna go into the bathroom and see if anything is displaced, if the man is asleep maybe the toothbrush is still wet.

**Chandu:** *Not the toothbrush, visually. The sink, however, has signs of recent use.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Then I'll have to peek the keyhole and listen.

**Chandu:** *You'll have to Pry that Window Open, my friend...*

**Chandu:** *Hit that BLIND stealth again...*

**Chandu:** *This window is of the same make as the office's. You find the same spot with your combat knife, and shank it open.*

**Chandu:** *It's swung. You can proceed.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna peep the keyhole and listen.

**Chandu:** *First, it's dark in the room. You can't see jack shit, but you hear soft breathing.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** The bathroom is too small for the whole squad to pile up in. I gotta go inside.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm tac wielding the pistol and the knife.

**Chandu:** *You can push the door open at your leisure. Proceed.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Softly.

**Chandu:** *You step inside. It's cozy-- you can see the outline of sofa set and a few seats.*

**Chandu:** *The soft breathing continues. Let's not kill your momentum, and proceed.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Is this carpet or hard floor?

**Chandu:** *It's tiles. The carpet itself is under that table.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm thinking of taking my shoes and rifle off to not clack around.

**Chandu:** *You can do so, exchanging the rest of your turn for it.*

**Chandu:** *Call it.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I will. Someone else can enter here, but they will fucking hold in the toilet, obviously.

**Chandu:** *Giles is up.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Imma follow behind Mac

**SSG Michael Giles:** Wherever he went

**Chandu:** *The window's open, you can hop in.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Ok that's it, no 3rd.

**SSG Michael Giles:** Hopping in.

**Chandu:** *Carlyle, Nuair, we can assume you're watching the corners outside.*

**Chandu:** *Back to the shoeless Mac.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Here we go.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** They say never look at the victim before killing them, lest the goosebumps rise.

**Chandu:** *You indeed see a figure, sleeping on the bed. That's where the soft breathing comes from.*

**Chandu:** *Describe your action. The figure is defenseless.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** A military man will not breathe softly while asleep. Is this a woman?

**Chandu:** *You pause and squint in the darkness.*

**Chandu:** *That's right.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I would take a moment to gag her and make her talk if she had a hint of... wait...

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** French...

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I think we could pull this off.

**Chandu:** *Giles is behind you, and the best French speaker is just outside. Next turn.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna signal him to come manhandle this whore, I'll put the gun in her face.

**Chandu:** *GILES?*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Yea

**SSG Michael Giles:** I'm here.

**SSG Michael Giles:** I'm going in.

**SSG Michael Giles:** Creeping.

**Chandu:** *Alright. Describe your action, you know what Mac is going for.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** First things first I'm gonna lock this fucking door against any intrusions.

**SSG Michael Giles:** I'mma hold her down with a hand on her mouth and shush her.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Then tell Giles that if she doesn't tell us where Lung is she's going to die.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Or if she screams.

**Chandu:** *Good thinking. We can say you got around to that as Giles made his way over next to her.*

**Chandu:** *Giles, as you put one hand over her mouth and another on her arm, pushing her against the bed...*

**Chandu:** *Well, obviously, she wakes up.*

**Woman:** "Mmph--mpppph!!"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Cillian is pointing a gun straight into her eyes as he gives Giles the instructions.

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Bitch - your only words are going to be the location of Lung. If you scream or say anything else you die. You got that?" in French.

**Woman:** Although disoriented, she can see the silhouette against the bathroom light's shine. She settles down.

**Woman:** Woman rolls **Success** -> 18 (Rolling POW Target: 50%)

**Woman:** A drop of sweat is making it way down her brow... not that you'd know.

**Woman:** She appears to nod.

**SSG Michael Giles:** I slowly remove my hand from her mouth.

**Woman:** "He... his lover. The bitch..."

**Woman:** "But please, my children. Let me get to them."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Where are they?"

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Bitch - did you not understand me? Lung - where he at?"

**Woman:** She points towards the door. "Down the hall, the first door to the left..."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Giles. You don't have to do this if you don't want to."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** He holsters his gun.

**SSG Michael Giles:** "You do yo thang, man."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna do what's necessary, bare hands.

**Chandu:** *Describe it.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles will head to the door, then.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm pinning her against the bed and strangling the life out of her, before tucking her in as if nothing happened.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Should make no noise.

**Chandu:** *She resists as well as a 5-foot something Asian woman can. She looks into your eyes with a pleading look on her face and you choke her harder.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** All I'm thinking of is my rifle and my boots in the bathroom.

**Chandu:** *Finally, she stops moving. After a moment longer, she stops breathing.*

**Chandu:** *NEXT TURN.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** They went in through this window right?

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Or the next one.

**Chandu:** *That's right. We expect Carlyle to want to do the same.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "There's probably a guard outside", I whisper.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** If the idea is to follow them in then that's what I'm doing.

**Chandu:** *You can both proceed up ahead into the room. Moving you.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Nolan can carefully open that door and go past I'm gonna spend my turn re-equipping.

**Chandu:** *You see an unmoving body on the bed as Mac finishes tying his boots up.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Giles is watching the door right?

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I can open it..

**Chandu:** *That's right. You can crack it open very slowly.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I do so.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Did you seriously..?"

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I move in lean and mean.

**Chandu:** *Corridor. Light's off, but you can see faint light coming from under the door down a ways there.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** He doesn't respond as he checks the safety on his rifle.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I keep a fair distance from the door and wait.

**Chandu:** *Right on.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Can I move a little?

**Chandu:** *Yup.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** First door to left, isn't that the room the office connects to?

**Chandu:** *Giles, a reminder: you're on PRIMARY, meaning you're using your M60 indoors. JUsT double checking.*

**Chandu:** *That's for you to Find Out, my friend.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Yep.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Can I try to feel if these walls are dividing or structural.

**Chandu:** *Which, specifically?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** One between the office and the bedroom and one between the space south of the hallway

**Chandu:** *You can lightly knock on the walls around you as you walk a little ways down the corridor, you can tell that... THIS one...*

**Chandu:** *Must have tiles on the other side, from the soft echo.*

**Chandu:** *Meaning it's dividing, if you'd put it that way.*

**Chandu:** *PROCEED.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Last time we peeked from the office door Giles saw no one so lets just go down the hallway.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** He only heard.

**Chandu:** *Hit the move. Nuair is up ahead.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna listen/see.

**Chandu:** *You put your ear up to the door. Fuck all. Faintest light coming from under it, however.*

**Chandu:** *End turn?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna open and make the turn

**Chandu:** *You can hit it. We assume that you're using the same stealth you've been up to this point.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Nothing?

**Chandu:** *Nothing. It's a sort of distributor middle-room.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** This room fucking sucks, I wanna drop prone. Visible from all windows.

**Chandu:** *Hit the status effect, and we proceed onto the next turn.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles follows behind MAc.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Obviously you see him crawling.

**SSG Michael Giles:** I crawl behind him.

**Chandu:** *You can apply the Prone status effect in advance and prepare to tread along with him.*

**Chandu:** *Carlyle, you're up. As you get ready to follow the rest down the hallway, you can't help but take a look at the now LIMP, unarmed woman lying on the bed.*

**Chandu:** *You can go ahead and move.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I kinda tucked her in, no one's gonna know until tomorrow.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I follow Cillian's lead and think myself lucky that I won't be near any of these guys again once this is over. Crawling, of course.

**Chandu:** *Move on up.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm signalling Nolan to go check through that window below us.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Wait, are those stairs? Looks really like a window.

**Chandu:** *Which? This is a window, specifically.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** That one, ok.

**Chandu:** *And that's a door.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Go hit it.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I peer in.

**Chandu:** *Through the door? Very well...*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I told him to do it thru the window

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** The window

**Chandu:** *The window itself is... actually, open. Curtain's drawn, but it's been left open so as to let the air flow in.*

**Chandu:** *You can see two sillhouettes lying on the king size bed inside.*

**Chandu:** *Of course, you can't distinguish them.*

**Chandu:** *What's the plan here?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I signal to hold.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Let them sleep.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I signal that there are two inside.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'll listen in. Snoring?

**Chandu:** *Sure. Two people, confirmed.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Locked?

**Chandu:** *You try the lock. And it is...*

**Chandu:** 2

**Chandu:** *Unlocked. What luck.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Piece of cake. No need to fake it, if he's snoring he's out cold.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm getting up, can someone fall behind me?

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I will.

**Chandu:** *Nuair can support your action as you go.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm not going to kill Lung immediately, I need her to hold the woman down. Permanently.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Giles will also have to interpret, or Bryan.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Bryan hasn't been doing a lot of fuck all so I want him on this. His french is better.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** Sure thing.

**Chandu:** *Then we can move up to the point the four of you are ready to move up. We're stacking you.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm going in with my tac wield.

**Chandu:** *MAC... hit a STEALTH roll. This will be no mods, because the circumstance is out of your control.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 19  
(Rolling Stealth Target: 70%)

**Chandu:** *Interesting. You hear the faintest sign of a creak as you push the door open, slowly. You instinctively pull the handle up, relieving the pressure on the hinges.*

**Chandu:** *You silently push the rest of it open.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I want Nolan to just kill the bitch with a knife. Bryan on my six.

**Chandu:** *You cans see them now. Man and woman.*

**Chandu:** *Describe your actions.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna straddle Lung and put my knife inside of his mouth. Not too much pressure to cut him seriously, but I need it in there.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** He'll talk.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I don't know if killing the guy's lover or whatever is gonna make him cooperate much.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Then don't do it before my signal.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I'll get on top of her and hold a knife to her throat as MacAllister grabs him.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Where's Bryan?

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I'll also hold her mouth.

**Chandu:** *Right there. You both succeed at your respective actions. Giles holds the door down outside while you three are in here.*

**Chandu:** *The both of them shake awake, startled.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Bryan. He has one chance to get this right. If he doesn't tell me where Ming is his tongue will hang outside his windpipe shortly."

**Lung Li Bao:** He's looking over the three of you in contempt...

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna pull out the knife juust enough for him to talk but not comfortably scream.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "The good fellow holding that knife says you'll tell him where Ming is or he'll mutilate you." I say, in French.

**Lung Li Bao:** "Ming Yuan? You want Ming Yuan?" He whispers, being careful not to cut himself with the knife partly in his mouth.

**Lung Li Bao:** "Haha... of course..."

**Lung Li Bao:** Lung Li Bao rolls **Failure** -> 71 (Rolling POW Target: 55%)

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "What else did you expect? You could have sold dope all your life if you didn't mess with him."

**Lung Li Bao:** "I..." he gulps at your words.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Wrong answer." I'm gonna clench his jaw and give him half a Glasgow smile.

**Lung Li Bao:** He clenches his teeth, holding in a scream.

**Lung Li Bao:** Lung Li Bao lost 2 HP! 10 → 8

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Let's try that again."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I'm about to say something else but it's turned into an abject FUCKING HELL as Cillian cuts the poor guy senseless.

**Lung Li Bao:** "I know how this ends... don't let my children see my body."

**Lung Li Bao:** "The workshop, north of here."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Wrong answer again."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** He continues.

**Lung Li Bao:** "ARGH-"

**Lung Li Bao:** 1

**Lung Li Bao:** Lung Li Bao lost 2 HP! 8 → 6

**Lung Li Bao:** "The... phhuuckhning... workshoph..."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "I can do this all day."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Take it easy, for fucks sake!" I'm about to pry Cillian away as it begins to look like he's torturing Lung for fun.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** How does he react?

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** HUMINT?

**Lung Li Bao:** You can hit HUMINT, sure.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Failure** -> 67  
(Rolling HUMINT Target: 50%)

**Lung Li Bao:** He's easy to read at this point, since you're holding his fucking head up with a knife trailing across his cheek. That can be a +20% bonus.

**Lung Li Bao:** You can determine that he's out for his own skin, and genuinely trying to throw Ming under the bus for his own sake.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Well then. Bonne nuit." I'm gonna finish this and put it in his heart and twist it.

**Lung Li Bao:** //////////////////////////////////////////////////////////////////// Goes straight through the chest. Coughs blood and shudders before collapsing.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I nod to Nolan.

**Lung Li Bao:** Lung Li Bao lost 6 HP! 6 → 0

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I slit her throat.

**Young Woman:** Young Woman lost 10 HP! 10 → 0

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Get the camera."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We're going to take proof, tuck them in and lock this room from the outside.

**Chandu:** *The chick dies with pretty much nothing more than a whimper, while Lung chokes in his own blood.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Nuair casually sheaths his knife and takes out his Argus C3.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Does this fucker have any good trophies? Like a gold plated TT-33?

**Chandu:** *Carlyle-- you've seen your share of gore. Still... you must use the SANLOSS macro right now.*

**Chandu:** *Cillian. This man has nothing more in his fuckpad than a Marakov PM.*

**Chandu:** *That would've been so cool if he had, though!*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Too bad. We have things to do.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We already know that there's an effigy pointed at the courtyard, we'll have to circle around.

**Chandu:** *ALRIGHT. We can proceed. Nuair-- you have the picture of Lung and his lover, both killed in bed.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Get us out the same way we came and let's close in on the workshop from the far end.

**Chandu:** *Tracking your steps back is a simple matter.*

**Chandu:** *On the way back to the corridor, Giles, you're the last to enter. You take a look through the window to the left.*

**Chandu:** *Oh. That's his kid.*

**Chandu:** *So peacefully, he sleeps. What do you think?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Excuse me what?

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Yeah we are obviously getting out of here.

**SSG Michael Giles:** I'm not fucking with no kid, man.

**SSG Michael Giles:** Let's get.

**Chandu:** *You do so.*

**Chandu:** *The home invasion went more smoothly than anyone expected.*

**Chandu:** *You can trace the contour of the ruins to get to the workshop. Since we're running short on time, that's what we want to do, yes?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Only two civilians for an officer, practically the most efficient unit inside Vietnam right now.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** We didn't even need Giles to work his black magic.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Exactly. Let's get there.

**Chandu:** *LOADING...*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Do we see/hear anyone outside?

**Chandu:** *You hear no movement. In fact, it's quite quiet up here.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** This place is multistory and presumably not made of brick and mortar so I think we could simply scale up to the 2nd floor by climbing.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Possible?

**Chandu:** *That's a possibility. This building is particularly climbable through the ventilation exhausts which seem...*

**Chandu:** *Not to come from the ground level.*

**Chandu:** *You can use them to climb. One moment.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Let's hit it.

**Chandu:** *Alright. You're up by the window, picture this. Trying to open it with the knife will require a little more dexterity than before.*

**Chandu:** *Hit a quick roll.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Dex?

**Chandu:** *That's right.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Failure** -> 98  
(Rolling DEX Target: 60%)

**Chandu:** *Hanging onto the exhaust pipe with one arm, you bring your knife down on the window harder than you meant to, after losing your balance. You've broken the window open.*

**Chandu:** *You can head on through.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Let's do so.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Where are our tokens even meant to be

**Chandu:** *Hold up!*

**Chandu:** *There. You're in a bedroom.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Is it possible to put something against it so it doesn't beam light outside.

**Chandu:** *Can you all see inside the room, real quick?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I can. No lights.

**SSG Michael Giles:** yes

**Chandu:** *Alright. You can slide a bookshelf over to cover the little balcony.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We do so.

**Chandu:** *It's not the huge kind, so it's a quick matter. It's covered.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** This is the bedroom. Does Bryan want to find anything?

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm looking at him as if expecting him to do something right now.

**Chandu:** *This bedroom feels more like a guest bedroom than a main facility, you can tell this much right off the bat. It feels like it hasn't been touched for a while.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I'll hit search to see if anything's worth looking at?

**Chandu:** *Drop the roll.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** IA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Failure** -> 80 (Rolling Search Target: 60%)

**Chandu:** *You tumble over some shit in the wardrobe. A box comes open.*

**Chandu:** *From inside the cardboard box, a... sort of rock rolls over to your feet.*

**Chandu:** *It's a ball-shaped stone, it's small enough to fit in your hand. You can't see much in the darkness, but you see a little green glint on it.*

**Chandu:** *You can pick it up and get a closer look at it.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Not interested, but he can.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I'll give it a look, sure...

**Chandu:** *Very good. You pick it up. It's smaller than a baseball. Holding it up against the light, you'd guess that it's made of jade or one such minerals so very popular in Southeast Asia.*

**Chandu:** *The shape, there's more to it than a mere ball.*

**Chandu:** *It's a polished ring. Looking at it closer, it's carved with some sort of cryptic symbols. You hold it up closer, trying to see if you can tell what language that is.*

**Chandu:** *You start following the inscription along the surface.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I'm about ready to drop it now before I go mad.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'll do that for you.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "We have no fucking time."

**Chandu:** *The thought to drop it crosses you mind, but you're too distracted following the pattern. Cillian bumps your shoulder as he says what he just did.*

**Chandu:** *You blink, Carlyle. Now you can act.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Keep it on the right hand side. Let's move."

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Just market garbage." I say, dropping the ring.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** His choice. I just wanna go. Carousel?

**Chandu:** *It's uncertain whether that is his choice or not. Carlyle, hit a POW roll.*

**Chandu:** *No mods.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** IA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Success** -> 4 (Rolling POW Target: 60%)

**Chandu:** *You drop the ring. It glints almost sadly as it rolls a little ways down the carpet.*

**Chandu:** *We can move.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** 9

**SSG Nuair A. al-Attar:** 15

**MSG Cillian F. MacAllister:** 12

**SSG Michael Giles:** 11

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Anything from behind here?

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I'm the pointman.

**Chandu:** *From behind the door? You can't hear any sounds whatsoever.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Let's respect the turn order.

**Chandu:** *Nuair, move up...!*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Opening up.

**Chandu:** *You put your hand on the pommel.*

**Chandu:** *A surge of electricity runs through it, as if you'd just tightened your fist on an electrified cattle wire. Roll CONx5.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 100  
(Rolling CON Target: 70%)

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm gonna shove him against the wall as soon as I notice this.

**Chandu:** *Though your fist tightens up, you let go at the push. You fall back on your back, still in shock-- you'll be stunned until the next turn!*

**Chandu:** 6

**Chandu:** *Correction. This was an amazing damage roll-- you'll have to resist out of your stun next turn.*

**SSG Nuair A. al-Attar:** SSG Nuair A. al-Attar lost 6 HP! 14 → 8

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I want to first-aid him.

**Chandu:** *You have the time to reconsider that when you hear the pommel being toyed with.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "AAAARGH! FUCK!"

**Ming Yuan:** 10

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Is the door open?

**Ming Yuan:** It's swung open. A young man stands at the other side.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm already aiming at the door I am throwing my knife at him.

**Chandu:** *You can hit it.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Athletics +20%

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** ?

**Chandu:** *That would be the appropriate roll, yes. We roll for damage.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 58  
(Rolling Athletics Target: 60%)

**Chandu:** *Roll DMG!*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** 2

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** 2?

**Ming Yuan:** The knife jams against his shoulder, making him recoil. He doesn't really react past that.

**Ming Yuan:** Ming Yuan lost 2 HP! 10 → 8

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Act again?

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm going to beat this freak to death.

**Chandu:** *ALRIGHT. You can go ahead. He's right in front of you.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I want to pistol whip him in the skull for 2x damage, bludgeon to head and all.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Melee weapons or unarmed?

**Chandu:** *I think either fits, with a pref for Unarmed since it's technically an improvised weapon.*

**Chandu:** *You can choose.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Melee is 70. Malus for targeting head?

**Chandu:** *Targeting a specific bodypart is a -20%, is it not?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 25  
(Rolling Melee Weapons Target: 70%)

**Chandu:** *Roll your dmg.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** 1d4?

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** 1d4+1 actually

**Chandu:** *That's what it appears to be. And then we BELIEVE... it is doubled since it's at the head.*

**MSG Cillian F. MacAllister:** 3

**Ming Yuan:** //////////////////////////////////////////////////////////////////// Skull cracking hit to the back of the head.  
Sent reeling forward, disoriented.

**Ming Yuan:** Ming Yuan lost 4 HP! 10 → 6

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Can I take my knife back and execute him?

**Chandu:** *Hit a DEX at this point.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Failure** -> 95  
(Rolling DEX Target: 60%)

**Chandu:** *You'll reach it in time for your next turn. Giles is up now.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** He got no stun from a skull fracture?

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** DAMN!

**Chandu:** *Just so.*

**Chandu:** *GILES YOU CAN ACT*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Imma run up to this guy and beat the fuck out of him too.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** we jumping him

**SSG Michael Giles:** Yep.

**Chandu:** *Hit a DEX to push past Mac without toppling his shit over.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Alright.

**SSG Michael Giles:** SSG Michael Giles rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 100 (Rolling DEX Target: 55%)

**SSG Michael Giles:** Man.

**Chandu:** *Owing to his weight, still, it isn't a death sentence. You push Mac out of the way, accidentally elbowing him on the side. His flak jacket catches the hit, but you've pushed him over...*

**Chandu:** *This way.*

**Chandu:** *You can act right now. You have your M60 in your hands, by the way.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Should I just blow his head off?

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Drop it and go for the pin

**SSG Michael Giles:** Doing that then.

**Chandu:** *Your 60 clanks on the floor as you put your hands on him. You're holding him down-- he'll roll STR to resist the grab.*

**Ming Yuan:** Ming Yuan rolls **Failure** -> 80 (Rolling STR Target: 45%)

**Chandu:** *You've got him pinned. His turn comes on in-- he doesn't have many options here, besides...*

**Ming Yuan:** Ming Yuan rolls **Success** -> 37 (Rolling POW Target: 90%)

**Ming Yuan:** Ming Yuan lost 4 WP! 10 → 6

**Ming Yuan:** Carlyle. The ring you dropped a few seconds ago-- it seems to take life itself. How's this possible?

**Chandu:** *Hit a SANLOSS roll.*

**Chandu:** *Only you, since you're the only one seeing this specifically.*

**Chandu:** *Macro, remember.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** Can I try and rugby tackle it to keep it from reaching him?

**Chandu:** *Parsed. As you frown, the ring elevates itself to hand-level and throws itself at baseball speed towards Ming Yuan's hand-- you can try this, sure.*

**Chandu:** *Roll DEX at -20%.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** IA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Failure** -> 53 (Rolling DEX Target: 45%)

**Chandu:** *A fail. You fail to clip the jade ring, and it's on his way to his palm. Let's see how dexterous he is with Giles on him.*

**Ming Yuan:** Ming Yuan rolls **Success** -> 8 (Rolling DEX Target: 75%)

**Ming Yuan:** He grabs the fucking ring, throwing his arm around Giles to catch it. Then...

**Ming Yuan:** He says something, in Mandarin. It's not the modern sort of Mandarin, Carlyle-- it's archaic. The closest interpretation you'd draw to this uttering is that of the saying "Needs must when the Devil drives," or something similar.

**Chandu:** *Giles, hit a POW roll Right Now.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** SSG Michael Giles rolls **Success** -> 17 (Rolling POW Target: 55%)

**Chandu:** *You feel a force pulling you down into the parquet floor. It's not Ming Yuan, per se. You reflexively let go as the fucker is swallowed by the floor.*

**Chandu:** *He seems to simply phase through it, downwards. Mac, Giles -> SANLOSS macro.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Is he just gone or downstairs?

**Chandu:** *Parsed. More than shaken, you feel a draw towards the basement level. Not downstairs. The basement.*

**Chandu:** *It's as if it is beckoning you.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Can I try shaking myself up now?

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** It's beckoning me like the smell of meat sizzling on the grill.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Get him up on his feet I'm drawing my grenade launcher and running.

**Chandu:** *Carlyle will have helped you up by now. You're still in pain, Nuair.*

**Chandu:** *ALRIGHT... we're going downstairs.*

**Chandu:** *Or, wait.*

**Chandu:** *Did you say taking the stairs down, or going back the way you came from?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Back the way we came from has a locked fucking door.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** But actually, when you put it that way, the M4 makes more sense.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I change that idea.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "WELL LET'S FUCKING DANCE THEN! AHAHAHAHA!!!"

**Chandu:** *I'll move you downstairs so that we're not fucking around with layers. One mo.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Where do we sense it?

**Chandu:** *It's further underground. Radiating from...*

**Chandu:** *This general area.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm frantically pressing the detonator and the emergency radio to get this thing started.

**Chandu:** *Within twenty seconds' time, you hear distant gunshots from down south.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** And the boom?

**Chandu:** *You can move freely.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm heading north and rounding that corner with partial.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I trail behind for now.

**Chandu:** *You hear.... after some more mashing the detonator...*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I wanna take the door in front of us.

**Chandu:** *(SFX) The target has been destroyed, effectively.*

**Chandu:** *Alright, you can move.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm rounding this corner also.

**Chandu:** *From the corner, over the kitchen window, you can see a hatch leading down.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I'm gonna NOT touch the doorknob and just kick it open.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "GET THE FUCK OVER HERE! NOW!"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "FUCK THAT ROOM!"

**Chandu:** *Living room, Carlyle. A cozy fire is on-- man's yelling.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Is there someone here? shit...

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "Coming!"

**Chandu:** *No, that's you yelling at everyone. You're determined to go over the window, I gather?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** If this floor is empty then let's just speed.

**Chandu:** *It appears so. You slam the window open and jump throw as you can.*

**Chandu:** *LOADING...*

**Chandu:** *The basement.*

**Chandu:** *You walk in down a rickety set of stairs after pulling the hatch open.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Where is he.

**Chandu:** *It looks as weird as you'd expect. Good question... hit a DEX roll.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 34  
(Rolling DEX Target: 60%)

**Chandu:** *You step to the side as this entire wall seems to collapse and shoot rubble directly at you.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I open fire.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 51  
(Rolling Firearms Target: 60%)

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **LETHAL** -> 10  
(11 Damage) (Rolling LETHALITY For CAR-15 CARBINE Target: 10)

**Chandu:** *Though you'd swear your fire is effective-- and wait one moment for the graphical effects...*

**Chandu:** *There. A sort of sphere has formed around Ming Yuan. As such, 11 damage is soaked by it.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** 11

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** 9

**Ming Yuan:** 15

**SSG Nuair A. al-Attar:** 15

**MSG Cillian F. MacAllister:** 12

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** You mean like a bubble or?

**Chandu:** *It's more like a refractive sort of surface-- the bullets aren't being soaked in nor deflected. It's like they are being dematerialized, reduced down to their basic components.*

**Chandu:** *Regardless, 'tis his turn.*

**Ming Yuan:** He lifts his left hand in a gesture towards his left, and up come...

**??? (1):** 8

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Shit... RETREAT!"

**Chandu:** *They look like the dead man you saw lying down at the ruins. Except for the fact that their skin is dessicated by now.*

**Chandu:** *NEXT TURN.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "What the fuck do you mean retreat?!"

**Chandu:** *NUAIRRRRR*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "Hey they know we're here now right?"

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** He raises his gun.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "ALRIGHT WE CAN'T FUCKING KILL HIM LET'S JUST GO!!"

**SSG Michael Giles:** ...Grenade launcher?

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Are we even in arming distance

**SSG Michael Giles:** If we get all the way back

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "Come on Mac what do we do?"

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "Fuck it."

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Nuair lets his weapon hang on the sling, taking out the soviet grenade from earlier.

**Chandu:** *Bad delete, but as said: each of you has ONE M67 grenade in his pocket.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm waiting for what happens when he throws his.

**Chandu:** *Hit the Athletics roll, Nuair.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar rolls **Failure** -> 98 (Rolling Athletics Target: 70%)

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Ah fuck.

**Chandu:** *Which was your target, again? Between Yuan and the soldiers?*

**Chandu:** *Since we're taking long already to resolve, we're going to handwave this one with a LUCK roll...*

**Chandu:** 2

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** a little behind the soldiers

**Chandu:** *The grenade, old and decrepit, not having been replaced since 1955 thereabouts, fails to arm.*

**Chandu:** *You're lucky it wasn't your standard-issue.*

**Chandu:** *Mac is up...!*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Since these idiots failed to adhere to my "RETREAT" I am going to single shot one of the zombies in the head.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Right one.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 24 (Rolling Firearms Target: 60%)

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** 5

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** 10 to head?

**Chandu:** *My fault. Indeed, that is where you hit. And the following happens...*

**??? (1):** ////////////////////////////////////// Skull is pierced above eye, releasing a stream of blood as the body sinks to the ground.

**Chandu:** *It's still standing, despite the damage. Black fluid is spurting out from the eye cavity.*

**??? (1):** Condition Changes Bleeding (Heavy)

**Chandu:** *GILES.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** I'm unloading on these fuckas with the M60.

**Chandu:** *Typically there'd be a malus from firing at such close ranges, but you can hit a HEAVY WEAPONS roll for a long burst. We'll sort it out.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** SSG Michael Giles rolls **Success** -> 60 (Rolling Heavy Weapons Target: 60%)

**??? (1):** ////////////////////////////////////// A deep puncture in the abdomen emits a jet of dark, red blood. Sinks to the ground as the pouring blood drenches clothes and stars gathering in a pool.

**??? (1):** ////////////////////////////////////// Pierces the abdomen deeply, but only a small wound with light bleeding. Deflated and unconscious

**Chandu:** *The two fuckers melt down by 7.62 fire. Though you'd expect to hit Ming Yuan from this angle, the same thing happens to your projectiles: they decompose as they touch the sphere around him.*

**Chandu:** *Carlyle.*

**Ming Yuan:** "DIE ALREADY! WHO ARE YOU!?"

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** "A blind horse always frightens itself," I say in Chinese before unloading at him.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** IA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Success** -> 46 (Rolling Firearms Target: 55%)

**Chandu:** *Your damage roll is unnecessary, for the projectives ARE INEFFECTIVE.*

**Chandu:** *NEXT TURN.*

**Ming Yuan:** His pupils peel back into his skull. He's targetting, left to right: Giles to MacAllister, around him in the turn order...

**Ming Yuan:** 2

**Chandu:** *It's Carlyle. You're hitting opposed POW rolls right now.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** Yessir.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** IA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Failure** -> 69 (Rolling POW Target: 60%)

**Ming Yuan:** Ming Yuan rolls **Success** -> 57 (Rolling POW Target: 75%)

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Hey idiot."

**Chandu:** *Not by much, but he overpowers you. You are stuck in place, unable to move.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "I fucked your mom if that pisses you off."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm fresh out of ideas here.

**Chandu:** *It looks like he is Emboldened by the comment, and... He slams the glass jars to his left on the floor in a fit of rage, and...*

**Ming Yuan:** Ming Yuan rolls **Success** -> 13 (Rolling POW Target: 75%)

**Ming Yuan:** He manages. He lifts several glass shards and propels them your way with the same aura that's protecting him from your PROJECTILES.

**Ming Yuan:** 4

**Ming Yuan:** 1

**Ming Yuan:** 2

**Ming Yuan:** 1

**Ming Yuan:** 2

**Ming Yuan:** That's 1 damage to Giles, 2 to Carlyle, 1 to Nuair, 2 to Mac.

**SSG Nuair A. al-Attar:** SSG Nuair A. al-Attar lost 1 HP! 8 → 7

**SSG Michael Giles:** SSG Michael Giles gained 1 HP! 15 → 16

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Put the glasses down and let's do this with fists sissy boy. You're like my wife throwing plates at me."

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I don't even see the motherfucker.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** IA Bryan Carlyle lost 1 HP! 10 → 9

**Chandu:** *He's stone cold and does not react to your hurtful comments.*

**Chandu:** *TURN.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I move and aim at him.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Can I see if a slow projectile can go past that bubble.

**Chandu:** *You could see if your BOWIE KNIFE could go past that bubble.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** That was my thought as well.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I'm not going in son.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm also not keen on touching that shit, the room is full of freehanging crap can't I just throw the first object off the floor.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** He's really cowardly.

**Chandu:** *Let's see. Nuair, for a better use of your turn-- you can grab one of these chairs and throw it at him.*

**Chandu:** *Hit an Athletics roll.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar rolls **Failure** -> 89 (Rolling Athletics Target: 70%)

**Chandu:** *Though you're still debilitated from what you'd been put through, the lot of you notice that he actually MOVED pre-emptively to dodge that chair, unlike with the bullets.*

**Chandu:** *TURN.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Chair didn't melt?

**Chandu:** *No, it just broke at being smashed against the floor.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "I have a feeling that you feel fucked right now."

**SSG Michael Giles:** Have we considered melee?

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I wanna touch the bubble slightly, see if it hurts.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Not like push my finger in it, just to see if it does anything.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "This gook thinks he's god."

**Chandu:** *It doesn't do anything to you. It's not so much of a bubble as a sort of visible area of effect, where even light is warped slightly.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm going in with my knife.

**Ming Yuan:** He's gonna roll that DEX to pivot around and make an escape while breaking your ankles.

**Ming Yuan:** Ming Yuan rolls **Success** -> 37 (Rolling DEX Target: 75%)

**Ming Yuan:** Hit DEX yourself.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 35 (Rolling DEX Target: 60%)

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Mine is lower.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Can I hook him straight in the chest.

**Chandu:** *Describe the way you stop him as he tries-- yes.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** With my knife, dead center.

**Chandu:** *As he swerves, you slam the knife right into and through him.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Talk without action is just shit, son."

**Ming Yuan:** ////////////////////////////////////////////////////////////////// Penetrates deep into the chest. Hands grab feebly at the violation before going limp and falls backward.

**Ming Yuan:** Ming Yuan lost 11 HP! 12 → 1

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm taking the ring.

**Chandu:** *He tries to hold onto it for dear life as you take it out of his pocket. You note that, though it's got a ring shape, it's not placed around his finger.*

**Chandu:** *He tries to mutter some shit before rolling his eyes back and going stiff.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm going back with the ring, and his head.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'm beheading him.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "We should put his ass on a cross."

**Chandu:** *You use your bowie to cut his shit clean through, parting through the trachea, esophagus, carotid, jugular, cervical spine, and whatever else you find on your way to the floor. You hold his head by the hair now.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Perfect. Can I hook him thru the nose with a carabiner through my belt?

**Chandu:** *His body starts losing its youth-- becoming old and decrepit. The head remains the same.*

**Chandu:** *You can. You do so.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "This looks gross. You guys done?"

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** He is talking about the lab.

**SSG Michael Giles:** "We got the mothafucka! Mission complete! Now we gotta beat the monsoon!"

**Chandu:** *EVERYONE HIT ME WITH A SANLOSS ROLL BEFORE WE LEAVE.*

**Chandu:** *That's MACROS SANLOSS*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** I don't say anything to or about this complete maniac and just get ready to get the fuck out of here where I'll never have to see him again.

**Chandu:** *You're all keeping it together so far. One thing is clear, what you've just seen, no human should have to witness, nor be able to do.*

**Chandu:** *You've killed one of the Kuen-Yuin.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "Lawrence would be loving this shit."

**Chandu:** *We've already stretched this session out for a while. Let's talk about exfiltration right now.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "If he got his hands on him this wouldn't last that long."

**Chandu:** *The main gate is under attack. The barracks and the southern inner perimeter entrance are on fire.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Where are the trucks?

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We could shoot our way out.

**Chandu:** *Over at the OUTBUILDINGS. However, roll MILSCI here...*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Success** -> 19  
(Rolling MilitaryScience (Land) Target: 60%)

**Chandu:** *The men who arrived earlier today to pick up opium (the non-Indochina Asians) seem to have made use of the confusion with Lung's killing to steal a quantity of morphine base from the outbuildings.*

**Chandu:** *Two trucks are on the move already, with a third being turned on. Lung's remnants have their sights on it, though.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Can we snipe the driver on the third?

**Chandu:** *You're out front by now, so-- firing at a single truck as a group should be a (not trivial) but simpler task than usual.*

**Chandu:** *So, let's say...*

**Chandu:** 34

**Chandu:** *Nuair places a bullet through his chest. The truck is unoccupied, and you can run across from the workshop over to the garage.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Let's get the fuck there and steal it. We can honk the whole way out to the back to make them get out of the way.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** If the rear checkpoint opens fire we got 4 guns on this bitch.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Bryan takes the wheel?

**Chandu:** *Who's got the best DRIVE?*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I only got 40

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles will be in the back aiming down with the M60

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** Mine is 20

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Hold fire if we're not shot first, no need to draw it in this clusterfuck, only shoot back if the checkpoint doesn't open.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** 40 here.

**Chandu:** *Highest Drive are all SOG with 40!*

**Chandu:** *So someone else takes the wheel.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** I take the wheel.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar rolls **Failure** -> 58 (Rolling Drive Target: 40%)

**Chandu:** *The guys at the inner perimeter were killed, but the ones at this watchtower have not been so. Still, you've got support.*

**Chandu:** *First, the stationary position.*

**Chandu:** 62

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** That's a **success** in FIREARMS from Kuropas, aimed HEAD on top of that. He blows one of the watchtower guards' brains off.

**Chandu:** *Giles, Mac, Carlyle, you're in the back and have an angle at them. You can fire, each of you.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Grenade launcher.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **CRITICAL FAILURE!** -> 100 (Rolling Heavy Weapons Target: 50%)

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Misfire!!!

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** So I do.

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** IA Bryan Carlyle rolls **Success** -> 19 (Rolling Firearms Target: 55%)

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** This thing needs a thorough cleaning...

**Chandu:** *This means that your shit MALFUNCTIONED indeed.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Not the first time it did that.

**Chandu:** *Carlyle, not much room for aiming. You're suppressing.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Giles can let the M60 rip.

**Chandu:** *Hit it.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Heavy weapons?

**Chandu:** *Yes!*

**SSG Michael Giles:** SSG Michael Giles rolls **Success** -> 3 (Rolling Heavy Weapons Target: 60%)

**Chandu:** *It's not a question: the volume of fire, coupled with sniper support, and the amount of targets, takes this tower out of the equation.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Do I clear the malfunction by now

**Chandu:** *You can have cleared it and tossed the bad 40mm out the back for good luck. Moving on.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We are switching the fuck out of the checkpoint before crashing through and past it not much room for maneuver here.

**Chandu:** *As you cruise further into the compound, you notice that some of Lung's men are even firing at each other-- you understand that the semblance of military structure broke with him, and the explosion at the barracks. Several different upstarts are trying to claim control over the remnants.*

**Chandu:** *Nuair, hit one final DRIVE roll.*

**IA Bryan Carlyle:** the lazy turk

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister rolls **Failure** -> 75 (Rolling Heavy Weapons Target: 50%)

**Chandu:** *IT GO WIDE!*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I got 9 more can I quick reload.

**Chandu:** *Hit the ROLL at +20%. NUAIR.*

**Chandu:** *QUICKLY.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar rolls **Failure** -> 91 (Rolling Drive Target: 40%)

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "These fucking roads-"

**Chandu:** *You drive over a pothole, nearly spinning the truck out, recovering at the last moment. Still...*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "FUUUUCHH-!"

**SGT Lawrence Kuropas:** Fire support from Kuropas. It's actually not single fire.

**Tower Security:** 1

**Chandu:** *Together with Giles, Mac's, and Carlyle's ongoing fire, the position at this gate is quickly subdued.*

**Chandu:** *You smash past the previously closed, now OPEN gate.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We need to ditch the truck and get back on the forest track, and that should be it no.

**Chandu:** *That indeed should be it. You've got an hour left over to make it to the airstrip at a "leisurely" pace. You can shorten that by cutting some rest and sleep out.*

**SSG Michael Giles:** Let's get the fuck out post-haste, I think.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** We should maximize sunlight time.

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** No need for a rush.

**Chandu:** *It's about 1AM. Following the standard route, you'll be there in 12 hours.*

**Chandu:** *AS FOR KUROPAS...*

**Chandu:** 2

**Chandu:** *He meets you right here. He's covered in blood like Rambo when he does.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** What does he think of the severed head on my belt?

**Chandu:** *He nods in an acknowledging manner. That's the most camaraderie you've gotten out of him since you picked him up.*

**Chandu:** *MOVING ON.*

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "The fuck happened to you?"

**Chandu:** *You don't even bother stopping at Sa-pi-sai, you just go around it to make more time.*

**Chandu:** *Kuropas explains in detail that he thought he'd make his own extraction by boarding the Mekong opium smugglers' boat and heading to Saigon as a passenger. They didn't like the idea, though.*

**Chandu:** *And that's that.*

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** Fucking freak...

**RT Utah:** By 1PM...

**Chandu:** *It has not started raining yet, but dark clouds gather over the sky.*

**Chandu:** *The crates are all loaded up on the plane. O'Riordad pops his head out of the cabin as he hears you arrival.*

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** "Brother."

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** "Wait." He turns around, digging, for some shit in the back.

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** He then passes you a plastic bag, Mac.

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** "Not dripping blood on my seats."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "Some fuckers just won't stay dead, y'know."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** I'll dump it in.

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** "Help me push her back. Gooks loaded the crates and left me here."

**MSGT Cillian Francis MacAllister:** "I'm too old for that shit. I think I'm gonna have a smoke. You got four able bodied men here."

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** Nuair follows Gabriel.

**SSG Nuair Afzal al-Attar:** "I got you."

**Gabriel O'Riordan:** "Attaboy."

**SSG Michael Giles:** "Yeaah, make the black guy do the liftin'."

**Chandu:** *END OF THE BORELLUS CONNECTION - CHAPTER 1: JADE PHOENIX.*